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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Friday, March 13, 2026

Date	Friday, March 13, 2026
Place	Senate of Virginia, Senate Chamber, State Capitol, Richmond
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- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EMRTTZn9-co
- LIS Senate minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/S

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[00:00:33] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:01:18] Senate Chamber.

[00:01:38] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:04:24] Senate Chamber.

[00:04:43] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:05:52] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:07:15] Senate Chamber.

[00:07:58] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:10:02] Senate Chamber.

[00:11:04] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:12:13] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[00:14:19] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

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[00:18:35] This is the Senate of Virginia.

[00:19:37] Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

[00:20:40] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

[00:23:45] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings,

[00:24:50] and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:25:13] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

[00:27:01] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

[00:30:06] Be sure to stay connected with live...

[00:31:09] The Senate will come to order. the Senators will please take their seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The Senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able.

[00:31:26] We will be led in prayer this morning by the Reverend Hung Su Lim from St. John's United Methodist Church in Buena Vista. And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing, will be led in the Pledge of Allegiance the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Aidan Moss of Lynchburg and Senate page Azalea Lehman of Chesterfield. Let us pray. God of all beauty, wisdom, and peace, we gather together mindful of the vastness of your

[00:32:03] creation. We see your hand in the mist rising over the Blue Ridge Mountains in the rhythmic tides of the Chesapeake and the quiet strength of the valleys that connect us. As the seasons turn across our Commonwealth, we pause to notice your presence in the work of our hands and the hopes of our neighbors. Fill this chamber with your goodness in the complexity of debate and the weight of decision-making. Grant these leaders a clarity that transcends the moment. Give

[00:32:40] them a wisdom, ensures every Virginian from our biggest cities to our most quiet corners is welcomed. Every voice is valued and no one is left to stand alone. We give thanks for the sacred responsibility entrusted to these women and men. We ask your blessing on their deliberations today. Help them to embody a spirit of mercy and compassion that softens the edges of disagreement. May their hearts reflect the kindness you show us. May the

[00:33:19] laws crafted here become seeds of goodness and justice that grow in every community guide their thoughts and their words lead them to act with the humility of a servant the patience of builder respect of a friend let a shared love for this commonwealth shape all that is done here driving out the shadows of division bless the families represented here and bless the people of virginia

[00:33:54] may we work together to strengthen the bonds of our neighborhoods and the future of our children in the name of the father and of the son of the holy spirit amen i pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:34:43] Clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll.

[00:35:25] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Thursday, March 12, 2026. The Senator from Chesapeake moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye.

[00:35:40] Those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 6.

[00:35:57] Ayes 34, noes 6. The reading of the journal is waived. First, the clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates.

[00:36:16] The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[00:36:32] any Senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 6. Ayes 34, noes 6. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communication from the governor. We do not have any Madam President. This morning the next order of business in front of us is the

[00:37:02] graduation of the pages of the Senate. I ask that we all turn our attention now

[00:37:38] to the voting boards for a five-minute video presentation. The chair now calls

[00:42:49] on the senator from Portsmouth. My microphone was locked up. Madam President and members of the Senate, we have dozens of guests and family members in the

[00:43:23] Senate in the gallery today and when the names of each Senate page is called, we would like for those guests and family members to please stand and please remain standing until the guest of the next Senate page is recognized and who better to pronounce their names correctly than the person who's been working with them all session Mr. Finch this is I just learned I was gonna do this about two

[00:44:01] minutes ago so we're gonna start with Hikmat Amand just step forward this way

[00:44:15] Gavin Tyler Aspel, Courtney Ann Astell, Carter James Berry, Max Callum Davis, Claire Evelyn

[00:44:52] Donohue, Ansel Asher Eastman, Evan Feld, Mr. President/Presiding Officer of the Senate,

[00:45:14] Davion Jeremiah Harris, Oliver Moore Holtzman, Edwin August Shields Kotkamp,

[00:45:32] Carly Rose Knox, Maven Morwina Lackey, and if I get this wrong please correct me,

[00:45:57] Vaishnavi Sai Lanka, Azalea Davis Lehman, Ann Frances Miller,

[00:46:16] Henley Irene Moser, Aidan Thomas Moss, Evelyn Rose Nazareno, Madison Michelle

[00:46:44] Nestor, Nicholas Christopher Pekarski, Lauren Ann Phillips, Raquel Diane Riceweber,

[00:47:06] Neela Saravanakumar, Olivia Ryan Schmidt-Cousins, Eugene Xavier Shelton,

[00:47:26] Caroline Elizabeth Shoemaker, Chance Mel Salt, Jackson West Taylor, Aubrey Nina

[00:47:53] Toler and Olivia Margaret Holtzman Vogel. Thank you Mr. Finch. Madam President and member of the Senate again please welcome the guests family members of these outstanding Senate pages. Thank you Senator from Portsmouth and I ask that

[00:48:31] yet again our senators give them the warm welcome of the Senate. Let's recognize the family and friends. The chair now recognizes the senator from franklin county then we will continue onward senator the chair recognizes the senator from

[00:49:10] franklin county thank you madam president members of the senate passed out on our green sheets because we love green sheets is unfortunately the 2026 senate page resolution number one you should have it on your desk and i now move that we waive the reading of sr1 all in favor of waiving the reading of this of the page resolution will say aye those opposed no

[00:49:42] the ayes have it the reading is waived seeing at least 15 hands we will take this vote again in a recorded fashion all in favor of re waving the reading of the Senate of the page resolution will record their votes aye those opposed no are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire

[00:50:13] to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 11, Nose 27, Rule 36-1. Ayes 11, Nose 27, Rule 36-1, the reading of the resolution is waived.

[00:50:31] Is not waived. Is not waived. I was seeing if you were awake today. today. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I now move that we, with regard to Senate Resolution 1, we pass it by for the day. Without objection. Senator, there is objection. We cannot pass it by today. Thank you, Madam President. You're

[00:51:03] all going to regret this. I'll give you one more shot. I now move that we recommit SR1 the Committee on Finance and Appropriations, where I know it will be killed. I believe the proper motion is to re-refer.

[00:51:23] President, you got me. I now move that we re-refer SR1 to the Committee on Finance and Appropriations, where I know it will be killed, right? That's where all mine went. The question is, shall the page resolution be re-referred to the Senate Committee on finance and appropriations. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators

[00:51:54] voted? Do any senators wish to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 2, noes 34, rule 36-4. Ayes 2, noes 34, rule 36-4. The motion does not succeed senator i believe you are now obligated to read the page resolution madam president i

[00:52:27] do believe you are correct as you are always correct um okay here it goes the 2026 senate page resolution number one a resolution of the class of big finch patrons amand aspel Assall, Barry, Davis, Donahue, Eastman, Fell, Harris, Holtzman.

[00:52:57] Knox, Kotkamp, Lackey, Lanka, Lehman. Miller, Moser, Moss, Nazareno, Nestor, Hikarski, Phillips, Rysweber, Saravanna Kumar, Saravanna Kumar, Saravanna, I love saying that name, Saravanna Kumar.

[00:53:24] Schmidt-Cousins, Shelton, Shoemaker, Salt, Taylor, Toller, and Vogel. Whereas we, the class of Big Finch, want you to get a load of this guy, Stanley, before he continues.

[00:53:49] Okay. And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, are like the brown-belted bumblebee, we are humble, hardworking, and found in all corners of the Commonwealth of Virginia. And, whereas we, the class of Big Finch, tried to match the buzz created by our Senate basketball win, an outcome that did not make us crabby.

[00:54:15] And the buzz on the internet, quote, the next generation of useful idiots, close quote. Pardon us, but, quote, that did make us crabby. And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, is glad our senators, grandma, clerk, and staff did not run afoul when narrowing the 122 applications down to 31.

[00:54:39] But speaking of fouls, the basketball game, ahem, of course we did win. I mean, I guess. And whereas we, the class of the Big Finch, made a slam dunk with our annual community service project benefiting Feed More Richmond, In nine weeks, we raised $13,389.

[00:55:02] Since this effort began with the class of 2012, $166,748.23 has been donated.

[00:55:19] Way to go, guys. And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, declare Lieutenant Governor Hashmi's open house and Governor Spanberger's executive mansion reception to be a win-win.

[00:55:35] And, whereas we, the class of Big Finch, thank Senator DeStef for the patriotism and the pizza, Senator Cervell for the pins, Mrs. Carter and Senators Boisco, Craig, DeStef, Headlock, Lucas, and Pekarski for the assorted Valentine's Day treats, but we may not be as grateful as Senator Stanley is to Senator Reeves for all those back rubs.

[00:56:01] One more, buddy. Come on. Trustful job. Later. Here. Yeah. We'll talk about that later. And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, were the first to experience the Courtyard Marriott Downtown Renault led by Justin Weeks, Daniela Snowden, and Cheryl Knight.

[00:56:25] And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, did not succeed without our homework manager, Mrs. Toxco. Our day team, Ms. Entzminger, Ms. Edie, Ms. Heinst, and Ms. Robertson. Our tutoring team, Ms. Gibson, Ms. Foster, Ms. Smith, Ms. Borum, and Mr. Koch.

[00:56:45] And our overnight team, a wonderful family that has always been here, Mr. and Mrs. Snow. Our amazing assistant leader, Ms. Trumbo, and Big Finch himself, Mr. Finch.

[00:57:11] And whereas, we, the class of Big Finch, promise not to put the Sen 826 keepsake license plates on our first vehicle. But the next class really needs a place to park for lunch, though.

[00:57:28] and whereas we the class of big finch depart the capital alert mindful aware attentive and wise thanks to our program partners all right christy dalton from feedmore richmond service project liaison laura brown and charles brown town and country cotillion on etiquette mason gatch challenge discovery team building cherry dale and tori felis virginia credit union on money management alexandra williams and aisha osborne from the attorney general's office on cyber crimes colonel john mckee sergeant diane dowdy captain chanda cross lieutenant reginald revis sergeant

[00:58:08] marcus briggle special agent jamie cosby jr officer josiah ivo officer michael light and canine titan and the pio caroline fry capital police public safety 101 and they learned that they better have a warrant right just remember that for later kristen howard from crime commission paul murray and gray smith fire services 101 caitlin barbieri and sarah harrington from the virginia department of emergency management on disaster response peyton townsend christopher newport university serena crosby brown elon university rachel campbell emory and henry

[00:58:45] university bre mercedes howard university britney mannipoli longwood university miles childs old Dominion University, Amy Rowcliffe, Shenandoah University, Will Stratton University of Georgia, Jerry Brown Jr., University of Mary Washington, Alexandria Rush, University of Virginia, William Taylor, Virginia Military Institute, Steve Milley, Virginia Tech, Gabriel Rayner, William and Mary, Introduction to

College Admissions, Alexandra Vanek, Virginia Service Foundation, and our Senate Page alumni, Maurice Jones, Ampton City graduate, Page class was 1979, and the former Virginia

[00:59:21] secretary of commerce and trade sam savino everett mercer luke dorn hannah fierro aiden lyons flora wiley reagan mcdougall diddy diddy say it with me diddy diddy and kate howard page class of 2025 ava sophia robinson of page class of 2023 and a recent united states senate page justin wilson page class of 1993 former mayor of alexandria john balaz page class of 1986 former richmond mayor

[00:59:54] city councilman sam towel page class of 1992 the commissioner of the state corporation commission joseph taylor page class of 1996 an attorney bryant thomas page class of 2000 chkd government relations graham bryant the page class of 2006 deputy solicitor general office of the attorney general thank you for sharing advice for being successful during session an infinite wisdom that that will carry on to our professional lives.

[01:00:26] And whereas we, the class of the Big Finch, salute those of you who admirably served and defended our great nation, Senators DeStef, Pillian, Reeves, and Stewart, thank you.

[01:00:47] And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, also salute those of you who put your lives on the line daily to serve and protect as law enforcement professionals. All members of our Capitol Police, State Police, and Richmond City Police, And Senators Craig, Diggs, and Reeves, please accept our utmost appreciation.

[01:01:16] And whereas we, the class of Big Finch, found a few factoids. Pay attention. I told you this is why we should have waived it. Senator Reeves watches cat videos and does a lot of Second Amendment shopping.

[01:01:38] I wonder why. Senator Stanley also watches cat videos. They're on his computer. What am I going to do? Miss Robertson watches turtle videos Senator Serval's red suit is un poco brillante. Did I get that right? Un poco brillante. Senators use their cell phones more than we do and female pages calling everyone in the dead of

[01:02:16] night is sus. We need to look a little deeper into that one. And whereas we the class of Big Finch know no jammies in the hallway, energy drinks should not be microwaved it is illegal in Switzerland to put contacts in your chickens eyes the weight of these pins could pin us down and the Senate of Virginia loves

[01:02:46] endless green sheets and paper in general Stanley can sing you've heard me so sing it boy it says and I will there's a song about mr. Finch you're a mean one mr finch you won't give the pages an inch i'll stop there you want to hear the rest of it

[01:03:21] let me know thank you oh you want more more why and whereas we the class of big finch we're one big happy hood and we would like to add carter berry likes strawberry lauren's quote bottom burp

[01:03:55] noises my personal favorite olivia vogel's 30 year old chain smoker voice lunches and peak voices cliquish, cornballs, cornfields, cackling, crash-outs, capstone campaigning, Caroline's Laugh, Cowpasture River crabs! Didn't know you could get crabs in the

[01:04:29] Cowpasture River. Big Finch room check casualties and whereas we the class of Big Finch can say I's 21, nays 19. I's 19, nays 21. Oh yes and I's 6, nays 7, R36 27.

[01:04:50] our six seven six seven there you go has that passed us by already i mean just starting to get that see what we just did there do you have any guard rails left to spare surveil's location there's an app for that and our graduation and completion of the program now therefore be it resolved that we the class of big finch gladly pledge allegiance to the flag but not to the house

[01:05:25] yes and remember that over there in the corner you new guys happy to have you Bennett Parker and Jones from the house and it'd be it resolved further that we the class of Big Finch admit this resolution might feel like a Christmas tree bill and we do not want to denigrate or diminish previous classes

[01:06:01] with a buzzkill sonication education pollinator pageinator knee do there Neato, Neato, Neato. Madam President, that is SR1 and I now move for its passage.

[01:06:24] The question is, shall SR1, Senate Page Resolution No. 1, be agreed to? All those in favor of agreeing to the resolution will record their votes. Aye, those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote on this very important resolution?

[01:06:47] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:07:26] Ayes 39, no's 1. How do you like the middle of Broad Street?

[01:07:48] Ayes 39, no's Hooter Line. Senate page resolution number 1 is agreed to.

[01:07:56] Now calls on Madam Clerk.

[01:08:28] We're delighted that so many parents are able to be with us today and I think the capstone program showed you how hard these young people have been working and how many traits they have picked up from certain members.

[01:08:46] I think we still have to have some workshops for the senator pages because they just can't get it right. we appreciate them participating. When I came here way back in the dark ages, the pages stayed at the John Marshall Hotel, which is a couple blocks up the street.

[01:09:14] They had no chaperones, they had no study halls. I know all of you would probably like to try that, but things changed. People started looking at the program and decided that first of all they needed adult chaperones at the hotel and the second they needed to have monitored study halls and with those two

[01:09:50] changes the program began really evolving and we have come a long way the pages have had a first-hand introduction to the legislative process and you saw today with the capstone session that they've learned a lot especially about where to walk and when not to move and that legislation is like making sausage it's not always a pretty process they've seen the good the bad and the ugly

[01:10:22] crabs in the cow pasture river at orientation i told parents and family members that the long that and the pages that coming here in this beautiful building is like going to work in a foreign country. You're learning a new language, new terms, new customs, and today I think that they were told right about that. We've watched a group of young

[01:10:58] people who were very apprehensive and somewhat overwhelmed at orientation learn time management skills, business etiquette skills, money management. They see Senator Cereville about the

Holly Mart or whatever that was you were learning yesterday how to adjust to a roommate which restaurants and delivery options are the best and that is not the tobacco company and how a smile can

[01:11:35] brighten someone's day without you realizing you've brightened their day we've also had several visits to the Supreme Court right guys some of you may need more but it's not them. And they've had many social events and job assignments. Parents we told you when you left your young person with us that

[01:12:13] they're not going to be the same when they return to you today. They will not want to make up their bed. They will want to go out to eat or order DoorDash every night as long as you pay. And we hope that you'll also notice that they are involved and interested in current events and they talk about these issues it's amazing that in their off time or down time that they're talking about things that they'd heard about on the floor

[01:12:51] or had read had read in the newspaper online and i've had several pages tell me in the past you know when i go back to school it's just not the same the things they talk about aren't interesting i want to talk about bills legislation headlines they want to talk about sports and dates

[01:13:18] benjamin franklin said tell me and i forget teach me and i remember involve me and i learn i know that our program teaches and involves young people from the moment they walk in the door of this wonderful building. Is this program worth it? Absolutely. We are here to train young people

[01:13:52] who are going to be the leaders of the future, sitting in some of these desks out here, standing up here, working in their communities, running for city council, school board, the many opportunities out there for them to be involved in their communities, and they are going to be the leaders of the future. I personally feel it's worth every penny we spend on this

[01:14:28] program. This is a new generation of the best and brightest for public service and we hope that this is a step forward for all of you. Today you got a shooting star pin on your lapel red for Senate and that's to indicate that we have all the confidence in the world as you go forward in your lives that you are going

[01:15:07] to be the leaders of the future. We want you to always remember to be involved in your community, your state, and your country. No matter where you go when you grow up and start your careers, always remember to vote because many women and men have paid the ultimate price for that right. We hope that one day some of you will be willing to fill the various seats that we just mentioned, either here

[01:15:47] in Virginia or somewhere else. As Texas legislator Barbara Jordan said, a nation is founded by the willingness of each of us to share in the responsibility for upholding the common good.

[01:16:04] That means looking out for your fellow man reaching back and pulling them up if they need a hand. We hope you will always remember this. We hope this experience helped you learn how, Sorry, I get emotional with this.

[01:16:39] We hope that this experience will help you learn more about how to get along with each other, socialize without using a cell phone or computer, respect each other's beliefs, and allowing people to have their beliefs and experiences and express them.

[01:17:00] We're going to miss your smiles, your cheerful greetings, your laughter, and all the questions you've been asking on those scavenger hunts. You are part of the fabric of this very special capital.

[01:17:21] We hope that you will come back and visit whenever you can. Be sure to wear a name tag because you were grown many inches and changed your hairdo, and we'll look the same, old and tired.

[01:17:40] So when you come back, please tell us who you are because, you know, the brain gets foggy at times. When I was a young person your age, we had a president, John Kennedy, and he said, ask not what your country can do for you, ask what you can do for your country.

[01:18:11] And that's what all of you need to do. In conclusion, there's a quote from Ruth Bader Ginsburg, and it says, fight for the things that you care about, but do it in a way that will lead others to join you.

[01:18:33] thank you for all you have done for the commonwealth of virginia and if you want as i call your name

[01:19:30] please come forward to receive your certificate and an envelope but do not open the envelope

[01:19:40] until we tell you all right hikmat amman of virginia beach gavin tyler aspel of suffolk

[01:20:11] Courtney Ann Astle of Nottoway, Carter James Berry of Fairfax.

[01:20:48] I'll tell y'all a story about Carter. Carter was assigned to the clerk's office the first week. And when they were leaving, he came back in my office and he said, can I ask you something?

[01:21:08] I said, sure. And he said, no, no, no, no, no, no, no, grandma. And I said, you want to call your grandma? He said, no, I want to call you grandma clerk. Now, I've been called mom.

[01:21:26] I've never been called grandma clerk, but it worked out, didn't it? Yes. Max Callum Davis of Charlottesville.

[01:21:46] That's someone else's. Good try. Claire Evelyn Donahue of Essex.

[01:22:04] Ansel Asher Eastman of Chesterfield. Evan Feld of Virginia Beach.

[01:22:28] Our presiding officer, Davion Jeremiah Harris of Portsmouth.

[01:22:47] good job oliver moore holzman of shenandoah edwin august shields cod camp of richmond carly rose

[01:23:16] knox of virginia beach maven morwenna lackey of hampton vaishnavi sylanka of fairfax azalea

[01:23:52] davis lehman of chesterfield anne francis miller of richmond kenley irene moser of norfolk aiden

[01:24:26] Thomas Moss of Lynchburg, Evelyn Rose Nazareno of Fairfax, Madison Michelle Nestor of Loudon,

[01:25:06] Nicholas Christopher Pekarski of Fairfax, Lauren Ann Phillips of Roanoke, Raquel Diane Riceweber

[01:25:34] of Dinwiddie, just one, Neela Saravanakumar of Prince William, Olivia Ryan Schmidt-Cousins of

[01:26:01] richmond eugene xavier shelton of fairfax caroline elizabeth shoemaker of williamsburg chance mel

[01:26:40] salt of stafford jackson west taylor of alexandria aubrey nina toller of hanover and olivia margaret

[01:27:21] Holtzman Vogel of Falkier. Okay. You have your white envelope. You may open it. You need,

[01:28:17] need to, excuse me, I don't have a gavel pages. You need to thank the members of the Senate for that. And one last thing I'd like to say, I am so proud of the diversity of our program. I think

[01:28:52] that's been one of the greatest changes to it. So thank you all. That concludes our program.

[01:29:05] Senate will be at ease the Senate will return to the morning hour and Reverend

[01:43:51] I ask that you wait and we will soon have your introduction as well thank you so much for your patience this morning but the senator calls the chair recognizes the senator from Stafford Thank You madam president I rise for an introduction the senator has the floor today in the gallery we are welcoming stafford county mountain view high school competition cheer team if y'all can stand look at this yeah i love it um mad president this is the 2025 virginia high school league classic state

[01:44:29] championship team right there um last november at the seagull center right here in richmond the mountain view wildcats delivered an exceptional performance they earned 287.5 points and they they defeated the runner-up battlefield high school by 12 points matter president their their routine really impressive judgment as a former to your mom I don't know if y'all knew that they really had remarkable synchronization I heard that their precision choreography and really an extraordinary display of athleticism and of course acrobatic skill really notably made this victory

[01:45:05] the first state championship in the history of the program the championship season was led by EJ Frentice I hope I pronounced that correctly at the VH classics player of the year and guided by head coach Lauren Hilbert who was named the VHSL classics coach of the year together with their teammates they demonstrated real dedication teamwork and perseverance that define the very best of high school athletics we are so proud of them and their success not only reflects that hard work of these really talented student athletes but also the

[01:45:41] leadership of their coaches supported their teachers families and the entire Mountain View High School community and our community in Stafford so it's my honor today to welcome these kids the Mountain View High School competition cheer squad to the Senate and to congratulate them on an extraordinary achievement and please join me in recognizing these champions for their hard work for their sportsmanship and for making Stafford County in the Commonwealth Virginia very proud I hope we can give them the warmest welcome of the Senate thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the Mountain View High School cheerleading team as we've heard from the senator

[01:46:18] you've had remarkable success we congratulate you on your hard work your determination and we certainly congratulate you on the achievements that you have earned rightfully over the the several months senators I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the Mountain View High School cheerleading team and all of their successes. The chair recognizes a senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, rise for

[01:46:58] introduction. Senator has the floor. Madam President, in the gallery we have a gentleman who has been key to our office, Joseph White, but Joseph is here today with his father. It's the first time that he has been to the Capitol and watching Joseph's work, so we really do appreciate the fact that he's coming to

visit with us from the Senator from Al White's area. If you could offer them the warm welcome to the Senate and thank them for hanging around through the page process to hopefully watch us get a few conference reports taken care of today.

[01:47:31] Thank you Senator for the introduction and welcome to James and Joseph White. Thank you so much for all the work that you have done in the Senator's office throughout this session. We know you've been a tremendous asset and I'm so glad that your father was able to join us and also observe not just the work that you do but the work of the Senate. We're delighted to have you today in the Senate gallery. Senators I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to James White and to Joseph White. The chair recognizes the senior senator from

[01:48:10] Loudoun. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I rise for the purposes of an introduction. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President Today's invocation was given by Reverend Hung Su Lim of St. John's Methodist Church in Buena Vista, Madam President. And Madam President, I will just say that I do not know Reverend Lim personally, but I had asked a reverend up in my district to come down and give the invocation today.

[01:48:35] And she was not able to make it, and so she called one of her dear friends. And as dear friends do, he responded to the call and came out to bless us with his invocation today. Madam President. And Reverend Lim has been St. John's pastor since July 2023. He has served churches in Winchester, Fairfax, Nelson County, and Richmond since 2009. Madam President across the Commonwealth of Virginia. Hungsu is passionate about studying and teaching the Bible and building relationships with people and sharing lives as a community. He's originally from Seoul, Korea, and earned a Master's of Divinity and a Master's of Theological Seminary from Wesley Theological

[01:49:13] Seminary and a Masters of Theology from Princeton Theological Seminary in New Jersey. He has been married to his lovely wife, Eun-Jee Kim, who is with him today in the gallery. They have an adorable daughter, Jamie, who is also in the gallery with us today. Whenever the reverend is not busy with his other responsibilities, he plays basketball and pickleball, watches movies, rides a bike, and simply plays with his daughter, Madam President. He is joined today by not only, well, I was told actually he has a friend in the gallery with him too is that is that right um kathy is kathy with

[01:49:49] you a friend who is who has stepped outside madam president um and so madam president if you would join myself and senator head who represents who represents buena vista in giving them the warm welcome of the senate thank you senator for that introduction and thank you so much uh reverend lean for your beautiful words of prayer and blessing for us this morning we're deeply indebted to uh all that you offered us this morning and thank you for staying throughout uh the senate page program i'm hoping that little janie will be coming back as a senate page in just a few years

[01:50:24] we would be absolutely delighted to have her and welcome to your wife unji kim as well thank you all for joining us and uh senators i ask that we give the very warm welcome of the senate to Reverend Hung-Soo Lim and his family Eun-Jee Kim and Janie Kim for joining us today in the Senate gallery. Is there any other business for the morning hour? Senator from Chesapeake. Thank you,

[01:51:01] Madam President. Madam President, I rise to request unanimous consent to introduce a Senate resolution relating to the retirement of Dr. Jared Cotton, Chesapeake Superintendent. the question is shall the senate grant unanimous consent to introduce a resolution relating to the reverend the retirement of chesapeake superintendent all in favor of that motion will say aye those

[01:51:35] opposed no the consent the eyes have it the consent of the senate is granted to introduce the resolution madam president senator from orange madam president our question unanimous consent to introduce two bills or two memorial resolutions. One of them deals with one of the soldiers recently killed in the conflict over in the Middle East. The other one is a memorial resolution for a recently deceased 90 year old World War II vet who I was very very close to in my district and I would ask for unanimous

[01:52:10] consent. The question is shall the Senate grant unanimous consent to introduce two memorial resolutions. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed no. The ayes have it. The consent of the Senate is granted to introduce two memorial resolutions. Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you Madam President. I rise to request unanimous consent to introduce a commending resolution regarding the retirement of a college president. The question is, shall the Senate grant unanimous consent to introduce a commending resolution

[01:52:48] relating to the retirement of one of our college presidents. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The consent of the Senate is granted to introduce the commending resolution. Senator from York.

[01:53:13] Thank you, Madam President. I request a unanimous consent to introduce a joint resolution relating to a memorial resolution for Nicole Yancey. The The question is, shall the Senate grant unanimous consent to introduce a joint memorial resolution?

[01:53:33] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The consent of the Senate is granted to introduce a joint memorial resolution.

[01:53:48] The Senate will be at ease.

[02:04:38] The chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I would ask that we recess until 12:50 so that we can have a quick Rules Committee meeting.

[02:04:55] Clerk will report any announcements. The Committee on Rules will meet immediately upon recess at the Chair's desk.

[02:05:03] The Senate will be in recess until 12:50.

[03:16:50] Return to order. Sergeant at Arms. Madam President, a message from the House. Please receive it. The Delegate from Manassas, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you.

[03:17:05] Madam President. I've been directed by the Speaker of the House of Delegates to inform the Senate that the House has agreed to H.J.R. 315 relating to judicial elections and requests the concurrence of the Senate. I thank the Senate, the delegate, the chair.

[03:17:21] This doesn't solve the speaker's issue.

[03:18:10] Yes, they found this other place in the code where it is, where it's getting at. You're not allowed to bring the gun into the garage. You say you're not allowed to leave them. We covered that with them.

[03:18:45] This just has to do with whether you can leave it open in your car or whether you can possess it on grounds. Possess it on grounds first. The session I gave you is the part that I passed.

[03:19:01] It's the only way to do it. We were trying to get away from it. They said they searched the code and they found it. It's still not allowed to have it under the other code session.

[03:19:22] The issue isn't storage and I realize it's possessing it.

[03:19:38] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[03:20:18] Thank you, Madam President. Somebody turned on my mic magically for me. Let's see. Madam President, I move that the rules be suspended and House Joint Resolution No. 315 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[03:20:48] The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the House Joint Resolution No. 315 be taken up for immediate consideration? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[03:21:04] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[03:21:27] Ayes 38, no, zero. Ayes 38, no, zero. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the reading resolution be waived. The question is, shall the reading of the resolution be waived?

[03:21:43] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading is waived. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, move that the resolution be agreed to. The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to?

[03:22:00] all in favor of agreeing to the resolution will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i was 39 no zero eyes 39 no zero the resolution is agreed to the chair directs the senator from eastern fairfax to inform the house of delegates of the House of the action of the Senate. The Senate will be at ease until the return

[03:22:35] of the senator from Eastern Fairfax has arrived and the Senate on its part is

[03:27:29] ready to proceed with the execution of House Joint Resolution number 315. Nominations are now in order for the judges of the respective circuit courts. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[03:27:45] Madam President, I move the rules be suspended. The Committee of Courts is just to be discharged further consideration resolution the reading of the title and grossment be waived and senate resolution number 166 be taken up for immediate consideration the question is shall the rules be suspended the committee for courts of justice be discharged from further consideration of the

[03:28:18] resolution the readings of the title and engrossment be waived and senate resolution number 166 be taken up for immediate consideration all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 no zero ayes 39 no zero the rules

[03:28:53] are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration senator from eastern fairfax madam president move the resolution be agreed to the question is shall the resolution now be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the resolution is agreed to the nominations are now in order for the judges of the respective general district courts the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax madam president move the rules be suspended committee

courts adjust to be discharged and further consideration the resolution reads the title and grossing be waived in the senate resolution number 167

[03:29:33] be taken up for immediate consideration. The question is, shall the rules be suspended, the Committee for Courts of Justice be discharged from further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title and engrossment be waived, and Senate resolution number 167 be taken up for immediate consideration. As many as are in favor of the motion will record their votes aye.

[03:29:56] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the resolution to be agreed to. The question is, shall the resolution now be agreed to?

[03:30:26] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolution is agreed to. Nominations are now in order for judges of the respective juvenile and domestic relations district courts. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the resolution to be suspended, sorry, the rules be suspended. The committee of courts adjusts to be discharged from further consideration of the resolution. The reason of the title and aggressive be waived and the Senate resolution number 168 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[03:30:58] The question is, shall the rules be suspended, the committee for courts of justice be discharged from further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title and engrossment be waived, and Senate resolution number 168 be taken up for immediate consideration. As many as are in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close

[03:31:29] the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. The question is, shall the resolution now be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes

[03:32:08] have it. The resolution is agreed to. The chair now directs the senator from Eastern Fairfax to inform the House of Delegates of the nominations that have been made by the Senate. We will,

[03:32:20] the Senate will now be at ease. President, a message from the House. Please receive it. The

[03:39:45] delegate from Manassas, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you. Good afternoon, Madam President. I've been directed by the Speaker of the House of Delegates to inform the Senate that the House has made certain nominations pursuant to H.J.R. 315 and request the concurrence of the Senate. Please

[03:40:04] Please receive it.

[03:41:14] Pursuant to the joint order, it is now in order that the rolls be called. All in favor of the nominees of the Senate as named by Senate Resolution No. 166 to be judges of the respective circuit courts will record their votes aye.

[03:41:38] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[03:41:54] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. The motion is agreed to. All in favor of the nominees of the Senate as named by the Senate Resolution No. 167 to be judges of the respective general district courts will record their votes aye.

[03:42:20] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0.

[03:42:36] Ayes 39, noes 0. The resolution is agreed to. All in favor of the nominees of the Senate as named by Senate Resolution 168 to be judges of the respective juvenile and domestic relations district courts will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[03:43:06] Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The resolution is agreed to. The chair appoints Senators Srinivasan, Jones, and Sturtevant to the committee on the part of the Senate to count and report the vote of each House in each case.

[03:43:29] The Senate stands at ease.

[03:53:40] The joint order under House Joint Resolution No. 315 will be resumed. The clerk will read the report of the committee to count the vote. It's necessary to elect in the House of Delegates 51, in the Senate 21.

[03:54:05] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I threw away my script, but I believe I need to move to waive the reading of the report. Senator, you are correct. The question is, shall the reading of the report be waived?

[03:54:21] All in favor of the motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[03:54:39] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The reading of the report is waived. Those named in the report as having received the majority of-- having received the vote of a majority of the members elected to each house of the General Assembly are declared duly elected as judges of the respective circuit courts, general district courts, and juvenile and domestic relations district courts

[03:55:12] for the terms that have been set forth. The clerk will call the calendar.

[03:55:34] Senate calendar for Friday, March the 13th, 2026.

[03:55:50] Conference reports, page two, House Bill six.

[03:56:10] The clerk will-- The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Prince William. thank you madam president um madam president asked that we accept the uh conference committee report and speaking to that senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president um what the conference report does is two things um it has clarifying language regarding contraception

[03:56:45] and unfortunately it removes a reference um in another code section uh clearly stating that minors cannot consent to sterilization but it's already taken care of in our Virginia code and so we thought it was redundant and so that was removed but the essence of the bill is still there and we ask that you accept the conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on HB 6 all those in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do

[03:57:22] any senator's desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 15. Ayes 24, noes 15. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for HB 6. Page 3, House Bill 77. Senator from

Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that we adopt the conference committee report and speak to the motion.

[03:57:57] Senator has the floor. Madam President, I am disappointed to report that I had to capitulate to my um my state delegate who did not want to include speed cameras in this at this point so if you are anti-speed camera you should be very happy if you like speed cameras um you should be very unhappy with me but um i basically thought it was a good idea just to get the virginia state police or the county police out there running radar for a start and i'll be back for speed cameras next year for this road that is in my district and one other or two other

[03:58:35] senators district so that's basically what the bill does hope we could put up even more votes for it this time the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on HB 77 all those in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[03:59:10] the role. Ayes 29, noes 9. Ayes 29, noes 9. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for HB 77. Page 4 has Bill 118. The senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you Madam President. Madam President asked that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President this bill brought together the stakeholders to ensure that we have transparent discovery that is provided in a timely

[03:59:49] manner and I ask that we adopt the conference committee report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on HB 118? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The

[04:00:25] Senate adopts a Conference Committee report on HB 118. House Bill 318. House Bill 318. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I'd move that we adopt the Conference Committee report and speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 318

[04:01:01] is the bill that reforms the parole board. I believe this is the House cognate to the Senator from Hampton's bill, if I'm not mistaken, which is already on the governor's desk, and the version that's in front of you is identical to what we already passed.

[04:01:19] So it just didn't get caught up with the Senator from Hampton's bill before it left its chamber, so it had to go to conference. So that's what it does. If we need more specifics, we can go by temporarily and I can explain them, but we've already voted an identical version of this through.

[04:01:36] It's my understanding. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on HB 318? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. I, those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[04:01:52] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts a conference committee report on HB 318.

[04:02:11] On page 9, House Bill 396. The Senator from Eastern, Prince William. Madam President, if I can pass this by for a moment, please.

[04:02:30] Without objection, HB 396 goes by temporarily. Page 9, House Bill 396.

[04:02:45] Page 11, House Bill 476. Senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senator agree to the Conference Committee report speaking to the motion. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, the House of Delegates, particularly Delegate Watts, worked a long time on the language of this bill, but the House came to our position and we wordsmith section C to make sure that it referenced other parts of the Virginia Code, but it did not

[04:03:21] include the full list of language, which makes it a lot smaller as you look at it. So, Madam President, I'm happy that we were able to work through this and it was a better product through the process the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report on hb 476 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change

[04:03:53] their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 39 no zero eyes 39 no zero the senate adopts the conference committee report on HB 476. Page 12, House Bill 505. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. Can that bill go by temporarily? Without objection, House Bill

[04:04:26] 505 goes by temporarily. Page 14, House Bill 667. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we adopt this conference report and speak to the motion. Senator has the the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate, this bill is the bill that

[04:05:02] extends the SIJS, Special Immigrant Juvenile Status, petition process to young adults that are between the ages of 18 and 21. The differences between the House and Senate version were primarily technical, I would say. They wanted to do it by redefining the word child for the entire juvenile code. We wanted to just limit it to the SIJS authority. We were able to do it our way, but just in a little bit different way. And so the House mostly came around to our drafting approach, which is what the difference was. So hope we can adopt the conference report.

[04:05:43] The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for HB 667? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts a conference

[04:06:11] committee report for HB 667. On page 14, House Bill 667, excuse me, page 15, House Bill 705.

[04:06:30] Senator from Eastern Fairfax, can that go by temporarily? I'm sorry, thank you, Madam President. I ask that that bill go by temporarily as well. Without objection, HB 705 goes by temporarily.

[04:06:50] Page 15 has Bill 836. Senator from Western Fairfax.

[04:07:07] Madam President, I move that this bill pass in speaking to that. The conference committee report. Oh, that the conference committee report be accepted. And I can-- Senator has the floor.

[04:07:22] Thank you, Madam President. So this was the education for all, regardless of immigration status perceived or real bill. So the conference report basically shifts the process for warrant review and handling of law enforcement activity on school grounds to guidance that will be issued by the Department of Ed in the enactment clause of the legislation.

[04:07:51] and the new version also specifies that the private right of action only applies to section b and c of the bill which handles the guarantee of access to education as well as the exclusion from school activities based on immigration status real or perceived as well as to sharing of sensitive information

about that status and what we really tried to do was just find a way to streamline the guidance and make sure that our schools are not unduly burdened in following this

[04:08:26] so i hope we will accept the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report on hb 836 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 21 nose 18 the senate adopts the conference committee report for hb 836

[04:09:03] page 16 has bill 894 senator from northern fairfax thank you madam president i move that we accept the conference report and speaking briefly senator has the floor thank you madam president this is exactly uh in the same posture that my bill that we voted on earlier in the session sb 341 that's on its way to the governor um the language is exactly the same this pertains to bullying in um our private schools it's charlie's law the um the difference that the conference report made

[04:09:38] which is identical to the bill that we carried and went out was that there is not um a requirement to send a report in writing to the parents but they must let them know for a confirmed case of bullying and i move that we all vote yes on charlie's law thank you the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report on hb 894 all those in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted

[04:10:13] do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 28 nose 11. ayes 28 knows 11. The Senate adopts the conference committee report on HB 894.

[04:10:31] Page 17 has has bill 931. The senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President move passage of the conference report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President members of the body this is exactly the same as the bill that you passed 40 to 0 a little while ago. The only difference the only change was the house had a enacted it right away the Senate had a one-year delay enactment we've split the difference we have a six-month delayed enactment with a couple of the regulations going into a pack and into effect right away which

[04:11:11] DB HDS requested and so the substance is all the same move the report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for HB 931 all in favor of that motion will record their votes I those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, no 16. Ayes 23, no 16.

[04:11:47] The Senate adopts the conference committee report for HB 931. Page 21, House Bill 1186. The senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President, I move that we accept the conference report and speaking to that. Senator has the floor.

[04:12:18] Thank you madam president. So the conference report is is very very closely aligned to what we had voted out of the Senate. It this was the AI bill in schools and asking the Department of Ed to put out guidance and also creating an innovation fund for schools who need supports the conference report changed the definition of our artificial intelligence and updated it to artificial intelligence system which has a more specific definition that the

[04:12:54] House Technology Committee wanted to use the new version actually actually takes tasks the DOE not the BOE to work with local school divisions to develop the safe and ethical use of AI guidance and it also creates some new data collection requirements on the use of AI in individual school systems like I

said it is very closely aligned and I hope that we will be able to accept the conference committee the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference

[04:13:32] committee report on HB 1186 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 1. Ayes 38, noes 1. The Senate adopts the conference

[04:13:58] committee report for HB 1186. Senate bills, page 34. Senate bill 200. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank You Madam President. Madam President, move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president members the body this had just this got thrown into conference because we had some technical amendments to make an enactment clauses the house version has already gone to the governor and there

[04:14:37] is no substantive differences and so this is once again gets rid of the through-growth measures and make some tweaks to the bill we passed last year and so would move that we adopt the conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for SB 200 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change

[04:15:07] their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 no zero ayes 39 no zero the Senate adopts the conference committee report for our Senate bill 200 page 36 conference committee report on Senate Bill 270. The senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor.

[04:15:37] Thank you Madam President. Madam President members of the body this is the same bill I just popped up about on the house side of the docket here about regulating recovery homes. Right now they're not regulated at all so if you want completely unregulated recovery homes to be in your neighborhoods you should vote no but if you want recovery homes to be regulated so the unregulated ones can go out of business you should vote yes which is why we voted 40 to 0 on the first go-around so we should vote 40 to 0 on the second go-around thank you madam president move we adopt the conference report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate bill 270 all

[04:16:14] in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 16. Ayes 23, noes 16. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for SB 270. Page 39, Senate Bill 358. The Senator from Hanover.

[04:16:51] Madam President, I move the conference committee report be agreed to in speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this is the converse of Delegate Watt's bill relating to community care facilities and ask that you accept it the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate bill 358 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change

[04:17:25] their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 39 no zero I 39 no zero the Senate adopts the conference committee report for SB 358. Page 41, conference committee report on Senate Bill 394. The senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we adopt the conference committee report in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I just explained on the

[04:18:00] House version of this conference committee what the bill did regarding AI guidance for our schools so unless there are questions I will forgo further explanation the question is shall the Senate adopt a conference committee report for Senate bill 394 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 37 those two eyes 37 knows to the Senate adopts the conference

[04:18:39] committee report for Senate bill 394 page 42 Senate bill 425 the senior senator from Henrico thank you madam president madam president I move that we accept the conference report and speaking to that senator has the floor thank you madam president this is a piece of legislation that we just needed make sure it was in the proper form it uh we had some back and forth but there's nothing of uh significant substance that has changed since uh we voted on this legislation last and so i move

[04:19:17] that we adopt the conference report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for senate bill 425 all in favor of that motion will record their votes i those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the Conference Committee Report for Senate

[04:19:53] Bill 425. Page 2, Conference Committee Report on Senate Bill 491. Senator from

[04:20:28] Western Fairfax thank you madam president I'm here and ready waiting move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that senator has the floor madam president I just explained the education for all despite citizenship status or perceived status on the house cognate to this so I move that we adopt it and happy to expand further if needed the question is shall Will the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 491?

[04:21:01] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[04:21:20] Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for Senate Bill 491.

[04:21:40] Page 44. Senate Bill 516. Senator from Charlottesville. Could that bill go by temporarily, please? Without objection, Senate Bill 516 goes by

[04:21:59] temporarily. On page 45, Senate Bill 524. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam

[04:22:38] President, I move that the conference report be agreed to and speaking to that Senator has the floor. Thank you ma'am. The conference report, the difference in this bill and between the House and Senate was whether it would be effective this year or next year. The Senate's position was the delayed effective date and that's what the conference report reflects. So I hope that we agree to the conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 524? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[04:23:16] senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 38 no zero the senate adopts the conference committee report for senate bill 524 page 47 senate bill 596

senator from eastern prince william thank you madam president madam president i ask that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has

[04:23:54] the floor thank you madam president we voted on the cognate to this bill moments ago in house bill 6 we voted 24 to 16 this bill conference report again defines contraception as an action taken to prevent pregnancy and removes a reference to a code section I ask that we adopt the conference committee report The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 596?

[04:24:24] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[04:24:42] Ayes 24, noes 15. Ayes 24, noes 15. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for Senate Bill 596. on page 50 senate bill 648 the senior senator from loudon thank you madam president president i move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor uh this is um a marriage of the bills um from myself and from um delegate mccullough that uh deals helps deal with um some of the issues that we have seen out of the town of percival that you all have read about in the newspapers um it just takes my approach and his

[04:25:22] approach and and marries those two bills together around president the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for senate bill 648 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 31 no 6. ayes 31 no 6.

[04:25:56] the senate adopts the conference committee report for senate bill 648 on page 52 senate bill 692. the senator from roanoke thank you madam president i move that the senate adopt the conference report and speaking briefly to it senator has the floor uh thank you madam president uh we previously adopted the conference report to the house version of this the other day we basically came closer to the senate position in the house the the main questions were just that

[04:26:35] we're going to let one of the school divisions be designated as a fiscal agent for the whole consortium and also we came closer to the senate position on how we're going to enumerate the members of it based on legislative members based on geography so with that i hope it'll be the pleasure of the Senate to adopt the bill. Conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 692? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to

[04:27:13] change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate adopts a conference committee report for Senate Bill 692. Page 53, Senate Bill 725. The senator from Richmond City. Madam President, just asking that we would accept the conference report, speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. We're just simply returning SB 725 to its original portion that passed

[04:27:47] out of the Senate and I would just renew that motion to adopt the conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate bill 725 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference

[04:28:23] committee report for Senate Bill 725. Turning to page 9, House Bill 396. The

[04:29:20] senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I'd like to yield to the senator from Richmond City. The senator from the city of Richmond. Yes, ma'am. We just would like to adopt the conference committee report for HB 396 and speaking to that. Senator has the floor thank you madam president we have just come to an agreement within committee to pass this particular portion which simply brings mine into alignment with theirs that that pass that we

[04:29:54] will not have cash games but allow for the raising of the age it allows for the moving of locations if an insufficient space arises and it does not accommodate the social organizations members and guests to another location approved by the department and i would just simply move the conference committee report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report

[04:30:28] for house bill 396. all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 25, nos 14. Ayes 25, nos 14. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 396. On page 12, House Bill 505. Senator from,

[04:31:08] senior senator from Loudon. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, could that bill go temporarily. Without objection, House Bill 505 goes by temporarily. Page 15, House Bill 705.

[04:31:27] The senior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, can that bill go by temporarily? Thanks, Madam President. Without objection, House Bill 705 goes by

[04:31:50] temporarily. Page 44, Senate Bill 516. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move adoption of the conference report. I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Yes, big dispute in this bill. The Senate position was that residential accounts should be called residential accounts. The House position was that residential accounts should be

[04:32:30] called residential customers. The Senate prevailed. So please accept the Senate report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 516?

[04:32:47] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for Senate Bill 516. Page 55, regular calendar, Senate joint resolution on third reading. Senate joint resolution 209, confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons

[04:33:26] communicated to the General Assembly March 6th, 2026. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the resolution be agreed to and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is the governor appointment to the Virginia Parole Board. With that I move passes. The question is, shall Senate Joint Resolution 209 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change

[04:34:05] their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. Senate Joint Resolution 209 passes memorial resolutions senator from eastern fairfax matter president i move the memorial resolutions on page 56 sr 134 to sr 161 be considered a block in the usual manner waving

[04:34:44] the reading of the resolution thereof with the understanding any senator's iron resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the title of the resolution the question is shall the memorial resolutions on pages 56 sr 134 through sr 161 be considered in the block in the usual manner waiving the reading of the resolutions thereof with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the title of the resolution all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes

[04:35:19] have it the motion is agreed to the resolutions are now before us in the block the clerk will read the titles of the memorial resolutions. Senate Resolution 134, celebrating the life of Eugene Hamilton Hurst Jr. Senate Resolution 143, celebrating the life of Mildred Harlow Scott. Senate Resolution 155, celebrating the life of Tony D.

[04:35:50] Volley. Senate Resolution 161, celebrating the life of G. V. V. Rao, PhD. The resolutions will be agreed to in the usual manner. All those in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolutions please rise. The resolutions are agreed to. Commending resolutions. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move

[04:36:28] the commending resolutions on pages 56 through 59 SR 135 to SR 165 be considered in a block by voice by waving the reading of the resolution thereof. And any senator disiring to move the resolution from the block will do so if the clerk has read the number of the resolution. The question is, shall the commending resolutions on pages 56 through 59 SR 135 through SR 165 be considered in a block by voice vote, waiving the reading of the resolutions with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. All in

[04:37:02] favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to, the resolutions are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the resolutions. Senate resolutions: 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140,

[04:37:26] 141 142 144 145 146 147 148 149 150 151 152 153 154 156 157 158 159 160 162 163 164 165 The question is, shall the resolutions be agreed to?

[04:38:04] All in favor of agreeing to the resolutions will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it, the resolutions are agreed to. Senator from Stafford.

[04:38:25] Madam President, having voted on the prevailing side on HB 894, a move that we consider it so a few members can correct their vote, it's on page 16. On page 16, House Bill 894.

[04:38:45] The question is, shall the vote by which the Senate agreed to the conference committee report for House Bill 894 be reconsidered?

[04:39:08] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[04:39:25] Ayes 39, no, zero. Ayes 39, no, zero. motion is agreed to. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you. Having previously explained the conference report for HB 894, I renew my motion that the bill pass. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 894? All in favor of that

[04:40:03] motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 16. Ayes 23, noes 16. The Senate agrees to the conference

[04:40:22] committee report for HB 894. Supplemental calendar, no period 1.

[04:40:52] Uncontested calendar. House joint resolutions on second reading. House joint resolution 116. Confirming the appointment of Fritz Sassine as Director of the Division of Legislative Automated Systems.

[04:41:08] The Senator from Hampton. Madam President, I move that we waive the readings of the resolution. The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the second reading of the House Joint Resolution be waived?

[04:41:30] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll.

[04:41:46] Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The rules are suspended and the second reading is waived. Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the resolution be agreed to and this is the appointment of Fristecines as the director of the Division of Legislative and Automated Systems. The question is shall House Joint Resolution 116 be agreed to. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all

[04:42:25] the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. House Joint Resolution 116 is agreed to. House Joint Resolution 203, Colonial Capital in the City of Williamsburg, Commemorative Session. Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we suspend the rules and waive the third reading. The

[04:42:59] question is, shall the rules be suspended and the second reading of the of the third reading be waived? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The rules are suspended and the third reading is waived. Senator from Hampton. Thank you

[04:43:35] Madam President. I move that the resolution be agreed to and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. House Joint Resolution 203 addresses VA 250s having the colonial the commemorative session of the general assembly session held in colonial capital in the city of Williamsburg in October again I move that we agree to the resolution the question is shall house joint resolution 203 be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the motion the house

[04:44:11] joint resolution 203 is agreed to uncontested calendar Senate joint resolution on first reading senate joint resolution 141 colonial capital in the city of williamsburg commemorative session senator from hampton thank you madam president i move that we suspend the rules and waive the second reading the question is shall the rules be suspended and the second reading of senate joint resolution 141 be waived all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the

[04:44:50] senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The rules are suspended. The second reading is waived. Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move the Senate Joint Resolution 141 be engrossed in advance

to his third reading. The question is, shall Senate Joint Resolution 141 now be engrossed in in advance to his third reading.

[04:45:19] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. Senator from Hampton. - Thank you, Madam President. I move that we suspend the rules and waive the third reading of Senate Joint Resolution 141.

[04:45:35] - The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the third reading of Senate Joint Resolution 141 be waived? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 39 no zero eyes 39 no zero the rules are suspended the third reading is waived senator

[04:46:09] from hampton thank you madam president i move that the senate agreed to senate joint resolution 141 and speaking to that senator has the floor senate joint resolution 141 is the senate version of the house joint resolution regarding uh the commemorative session to be held in the city of williamsburg in october and with that i move that we agree to the resolution the question is shall senate joint resolution 141 be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the resolution is agreed to memorial resolutions senator from

[04:46:46] Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that the Memorial Resolutions, we actually gotta have numbers. We're in the blue calendar. On page 2, HJR 280 through SR 71 be taken up in a block in the usual manner with the resolution thereof. With the understanding of Senator Resire a resolution be removed from the block. We'll do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution.

[04:47:19] The question is, shall the memorial resolutions on page 2, H.J.R. 280 through S.R. 171, be considered in the block in the usual manner, waiving the reading of the resolutions thereof, with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the title of the resolution.

[04:47:41] All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The resolutions are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the titles of the memorial resolutions. House Joint Resolution 280, celebrating the life of the Honorable Gerald Edward Connolly.

[04:48:01] Madam President, could that come out of the block? Without objection, HJR 280 is out of the block. Senate Joint Resolution 296, celebrating life of Nicole Guggenheim Yancey, Senate Resolution 170, celebrating the life of Carl Robinson Cornwell, Senate Resolution 171, celebrating the life of Chief Warrant Officer 3, Robert M. Marzen, United States Army Reserve. The resolutions will be agreed to in the usual manner, that is all resolutions

[04:48:39] except for H.J.R. 280 on page two all those in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolution please rise. The resolutions are agreed to. Senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that H.J.R. 280 pass and speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, this is the cognate to the memorial resolution for former Congressman Jerry Connolly. I heard a lot about him yesterday, the day

[04:49:15] before. I just ask everybody to remember it's four days until the holiest day of the year. Thank you, Madam President. Senior Senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the resolution. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Congressman Connolly's wife, Smitty,

affectionately known as Smitty, when we walked her down to the House, was remarking how intimate things are here compared to Congress. I think she's right. Thank you, Madam President.

[04:49:42] thank you senator the resolution hdr 280 will be agreed to in the usual manner all those in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolution please rise the resolution is agreed to commending resolutions senator from eastern fairfax madam president i would ask that the commending resolutions on page

[04:50:16] three of the supplemental counter and just page three hdr 267 through sr 172 be considered in the block by voice by waiting the reading resolutions there with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a resolution from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. The question is, shall the commending resolutions on page 3, H.J.R. 267 through S.R. 172, be considered in the block by voice vote, waiving the reading of the resolutions with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. All in favor of that

[04:50:54] motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The resolutions are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the numbers of the resolutions. House Joint Resolution 267, House Joint Resolution 311, Senate Resolution 169, Senate Resolution 172. The question is, shall the resolutions be agreed to? All in favor of agreeing to the resolutions will say aye. Those

[04:51:25] opposed no the ayes have it the resolutions are agreed to this or do you want to recess senator

[04:52:08] from eastern fairfax thank you madam president um i would move that we stand in recess until 5 p.m just give people about another 90 minutes 90 minutes the house is coming back at 5 p.m as well and that would give us about 90 minutes to knock out some more reports and we can vote

[04:52:28] vote whatever we got left and hold on one second man president senator from

[04:53:14] Eastern Fairfax stand by my motion without objection the Senate will be at

[04:53:20] recess until 5:00 p.m. the clerk will call the calendar on your pink sheet

[06:30:09] page two has bills has built of the chair recognizes the senator from Arlington madam president I move that we adopt the conference report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president the conference report is the Senate bill that passed this body there is one slight addition and that addition deals with employees with under the longshore the

[06:30:45] Longshore and Harbor Workers Compensation Act it's a federal act they currently have a negotiated employee agreement so they're exempt from this bill until 2030 and then they will be covered by the language in the bill before us I'm happy to say the house went along with our process of having phased in requirements depending on the size of the employer's workforce.

[06:31:17] As you know, DOLE has to issue regulations by July 1, 2027. And there's no impact on state employees until there's a report back to the money committees.

[06:31:33] That essentially is the bill. I do hope it is the will of the body to adopt this paid sick day bill. Thank you. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 5?

[06:31:49] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close

the roll.

[06:32:12] Ayes 21, noes 14. Ayes 21, noes 14. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 5. Page 9, House Bill 39. House Bill 19. The junior senator from Virginia Beach.

[06:32:34] Thank you, Madam President. I move that we agree with the conference report. I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 319 is identical to my bill.

[06:32:49] When we discussed the secretary, some of the changes that we adopted was my bill had the secretary of administration, the House seceded to that and then who the bill, who the report, the work group should actually report to in terms of the chair and the Senate, the chair of the House and Senate committees on privilege and elections and that work group should have that findings by November 1st. That is bill. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 319?

[06:33:29] all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 21 no 16 ayes 21 no 16 the senate adopts a conference committee report

[06:33:54] for house bill 319 page 10 has bill 425 senator from arlington madam president i move that we adopt the conference report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president what the conference report does is it directs d mass to provide 12 months of postpartum

[06:34:31] services to individuals who have had high-risk pregnancies and it directs d mass to conduct a study regarding the age of 35 or older in terms of an age impact on, has a risk factor or on the ability of mothers to have a healthy baby. We want DMAS to look at practices across the country and to recommend strategies going forward if, in fact, the age of the mother is a primary

[06:35:10] factor in an at-risk determination. And that's the bill. It combined the Senate study, which I just described, with the House element of continuing 12 months of postpartum care for individuals who've had high-risk pregnancies.

[06:35:29] I do hope it is the will of the body to adopt the conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 425?

[06:35:45] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0.

[06:36:03] Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 2, House Bill 569. The junior senator from Virginia Beach.

[06:36:24] Thank you, Madam President. I move that we adopt the conference report and speak into that motion.

[06:36:42] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 569 is identical to Senate Bill 518, dealing with prevailing wages. What we did in line 17, we specified the definition of a covered institution, meaning a public institution of higher education that has entered into a management agreement with the Commonwealth instead of a broader definition, a public institute of higher education.

[06:37:09] This also clarifies that specifically a cover institution sometimes referred to as a tier three higher education institution will perform services at the prevailing wage rate for projects over five million

while not charging the president set already for other kinds of institutions for higher education.

[06:37:25] The second what we also did was clarify what was made to exclude broadband and other telecommunication services regardless of whether such property or facility was installed under a federal, state, or local grant. We clarified clarification was made to ensure cover institutions were excluded from prevailing wage rates for projects under $5 million.

[06:37:48] And we also clarified to exclude public contracts entered into by the Department of Housing and Community Development or the Virginia Housing Development Authority for the Future of Financing and Low-Income or Moderate-Income individuals. And then we also, lastly, clarify that a labor organization shall be one of the defined as one of the several internship priorities that can challenge any bid, specifications, project agreements, or public works that violate the provisions of the bill.

[06:38:17] And with that, I move that we agree to the conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on House Bill 569? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Those opposed, no.

[06:38:32] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 17. Ayes 21, noes 17. The Senate adopts the conference committee report on House Bill 569.

[06:38:52] Page 18, House Bill 994. The senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that we adopt the conference report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The bill makes a very narrow and carefully limited change to Virginia's photo speed monitoring law.

[06:39:15] Currently, speed safety cameras may be used in places such as school crossing zones, highway work zones, and certain high-risk intersections. This legislation simply allows localities within Planning District 8 to authorize their use in designated safety red zones areas identified as high-risk pedestrian corridors and if anyone is looking for where the planning district 8 language is in the conference report substitute it's somewhere along the lines of lines 53 to 55 let me be clear on this the expansion only applies to planning

[06:39:51] district 8 and it is not a statewide expansion it does not change the existing program anywhere else in the Commonwealth. Local governing bodies in PD-8 would still have to approve the placement of any cameras by ordinance ensuring local control and transparency. This targeted approach gives Northern Virginia communities an additional tool to address pedestrian safety in corridors where risks are highest. This is the bill as it passed out of Senate transportation with bipartisan support and I renew my motion that we accept the conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference

[06:40:30] committee report for HB 994? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 15. Ayes 23, noes 15. The Senate adopts the conference

[06:41:01] committee report for HB 994. Page 20, House Bill 1041. The senator from the city of Richmond. Thank you, Madam President. I move the conference committee report. Speaking of that motion. Senator has the floor. Conference report simply ensures we have the correct agencies named and restores an enactment clause guiding the implementation of the bill's functional literacy components.

[06:41:36] And with that, I renew the motion to accept the conference committee report. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 1041? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[06:41:52] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero.

[06:42:10] Ayes 39, no zero. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 1041. Page 22, House Bill 1220. The Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President.

[06:42:27] Madam President, I move that we adopt the conference committee report in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. House Bill 1220 updates Virginia law governing the use of photo speed monitored devices to improve safety, transparency, and accountability in areas where speed, where speeding poses significant risk the bill authorized state and local law enforcement agencies to place and operate speed monitoring devices in three specific locations high school high sorry school crossing zones highway work zones when workers are present high-risk intersection segments located

[06:43:06] within 1,000 feet of a school where traffic where a traffic fatality has occurred since July 1, 2014. Drivers captured traveling 10 miles or more per hour above the posted speed limit will receive a civil penalty of $100. These violations are treated as civil penalties rather than criminal convictions and do not affect a driver's record. The legislation also includes several safeguards that you all have seen in other bills. It requires is clear signage notifying drivers that speed monitoring is in use 30-day warning periods for

[06:43:42] newly installed devices protecting driver privacy by limiting the use and retention of collected images and data and establishing reporting requirements to the department of state police and the general assembly on program outcomes the bill also allows the the bill also allows individuals to seek damages and legal remedies if enforcement actions are carried out with willful disregard for the law overall house bill 1222 strengthens oversight of automated speed enforcement

[06:44:18] while prioritizing safety in school zones work zones and dangerous intersections again this bill passed out of the senate transportation committee with bipartisan support for the and for those those reasons, I ask that we adopt the conference committee report.

[06:44:35] The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on House Bill 1220? All those in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[06:44:55] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 26, noes 13. Ayes 26, noes 13. Senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 1220. Page 24 has bill 1366. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrique. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move we adopt the conference committee report speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President members of the body this is the first of two bills in a row that together make up Senate bill 640 which is a bill that we passed out of here 39

[06:45:34] to zero this is a bill about the Department of Social Services and child welfare there's two components to what is our one bill 640 and the first component which you're seeing here in 1366 is about creating corrective action plans and allowing the state to take temporary control of local agencies so both

versions of this bill allowed the State Department of Social Services to implement corrective action plans for localities that are not complying with or federal requirements what we came up to what the resolution is is that if a locality does not comply with the correction action plan the state can take

[06:46:10] over local operations as they can already do for foster care and the locality cannot reduce funding and so this is the compromise that brought the two together I move that we adopt this conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House bill 1366 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the

[06:46:44] roll ayes 39 no zero ayes 39 no zero the senate adopts the conference committee report for house bill 1366 on page 27 has bill 1490 the senator from western henrico thank you madam president mad president i move that we adopt the conference committee report speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you mad president mad president this is the second part of uh senate bill 640 which the house broke up into two the first part's about corrective action plans this part is about

[06:47:19] centralized intake uh for this the state will take calls for reports of abuse and neglect uh it's important to note the state already takes 40 of these calls uh and make all validity determinization determinations at that point the investigations will take place at the local level the difference between the two versions in the House and Senate was really about timing and this is a more delayed enactment and so what's gonna happen under this bill and under 640 when we get to it is that the provisions for centralized intake are delayed until July 1 2027 and then there is a phased in implementation which will begin July 1 of 2028 with a completion date of July

[06:47:57] one 2030 which gives the state the time to do this right quite frankly and so I move that we adopt the conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for a house bill 1490 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate adopts the

[06:48:34] conference committee report for House Bill 1490. Page 28, House Bill 1524. The Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the conference committee report and speaking to that motion.

[06:48:59] senator has the floor yes ma'am uh uh hp 1524 uh simply um moves the or increases the number of rounds of ammunition that a magazine can hold moving it from 10 which is in my bill up to 15. that is a major change in his and i just move the conference report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for house bill 1524 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[06:49:39] senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 21 nos 18. ayes 21 nos 18. the senate adopts the conference committee report on house bill 1524.

[06:49:58] Senate bills, page 33, Senate Bill 199. The Senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that we adopt the conference report.

[06:50:14] And speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is the paid sick days bill that I just explained 10 minutes ago. So since I previously explained this, I renew my motion that this conference report be adopted.

[06:50:29] Thank you. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on Senate Bill 199? All in favor of that motion, please record your votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[06:50:47] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 35, Senate Bill 225.

[06:51:05] Senator from senior senator from Prince William and I go by temporarily without objection Senate bill 225 goes by temporarily Page 44 Senate bill 518 the junior senator from Prince from Virginia Beach Thank You madam president move that we agree with the conference report and speaking to that senator has the floor Thank You madam president

[06:51:40] SB 518 is identical to the previous bill I spoke of in House Bill 569 dealing with prevailing wage and having previously explained it, a move it passed. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 518?

[06:51:57] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. ayes 21 noes 18 ayes 21 noes 18 the Senate adopts this conference committee report for Senate bill 518 page 49 Senate bill 640 the senator from

[06:52:35] Washington thank you madam president I move that the Senate agree the conference committee report and speak in that motion senator has the floor the conference report for Senate bill 640 incorporates key components of the previously described bills House Bill 1220 and sorry 1366 and 1490 by the Center from Western Henrico to successfully address long-standing structural gaps in the Commonwealth's child welfare system that we originally set out to address this ensures that we take a very measured approach to its implementation and with that I renew my motion for the Senate to agree the

[06:53:11] conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 640. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for Senate Bill 640. Page 51, Senate Bill 658. The junior

[06:53:50] Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we adopt the conference report for SB 658. I speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This bill is identical to the previous bill I just explained. I'm turning this into a work study and making sure that the Secretary of Administration conducts that work study and also reports to the

[06:54:24] chair of the house and senate privilege of the license committee with that i move um that we agree to the house i mean to the conference report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for senate bill 658 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21,

[06:54:58] noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for Senate Bill 658. Returning to page, okay, returning to your yellow sheet, host bills. Page 3, host bill 67. The Senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I ask that we adopt

[06:55:35] the conference committee report in speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President we removed the phrase that from such funds as may be appropriated out of the bill that is the only change I ask that we adopt the conference committee report. The question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House bill 67 all all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[06:56:07] to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 21 nose 18 eyes 21 nose 18 the senate adopts the conference committee report on page 4 has bill 84 the junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president move that we adopt the conference report for house b84 i speak into that motion senator has the floor

[06:56:41] thank you madam president house parity force identical to senate bill 777 this is the pjm transparency bill and it just requires uh members of the pjm to record their votes the changes that we made um is they can need to explain exactly how each record recorded vote is cast by a utility or licensed supplier or its affiliate that's appropriate in the in the public interest but also the each description shall be no less than 20 words but no more than

[06:57:18] 100 words um as well we also made sure to opt out of um electric utility owned operated by municipality that we found common ground on that or an affiliate or subsidiary and with that a move that we adopt conference report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for house bill 84. all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change

[06:57:51] their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 22 no 17. ayes 22 no 17. the senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 84. Page 7. House Bill 196. The senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move we adopt the conference committee report in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, this is the first of three times we are going to vote on this. This is the Senate's version of the revolving fund that I carried. If you want to build housing and you think we

[06:58:29] have a housing problem, this is the number one thing we are going to do this session to get more housing built. This revolving fund is about building mixed income housing. These funds have been proven to work. They've been done in blue states. They've been done in red states. They've been done in purple states. They've built housing all over the place.

[06:58:44] That's why we voted for it 40 to zero. I hope that continues, and so I move that we adopt the conference committee report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on House Bill 196? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[06:59:00] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 37 noes 2. ayes 37 noes 2 the senate adopts the conference committee report for house bill 197 96. page 8 house bill 308 the senator from western henrico thank you mad president mad

[06:59:37] president i move that we adopt the uh conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor uh thank you uh men present members of the body uh this is a bill that i took over for the uh former senator from alexandria uh when he when he moved on into a lesser position and um you know we can't all we can't all be here and um this is a bill that he'd been working on for many

years this is a bill that the delegate from arlington had been working on for many years uh that we finally landed the plane on you know we had a conversation i think it was earlier this week but who knows with how time works in this place about vaping in schools the

[07:00:15] senator from Lynchburg cared a lot about that he painted a very dire picture and I said we'd have a bill for him this is that bill so I just just give me a sec as I go through as I go through this bill but madam president members the body we all know that liquid nicotine vape products have flooded the markets in recent years without a lot of oversight or regulatory message measures we know that they have oftentimes found themselves into the hands of underage people and they are in the schools the senator from Lynchburg is not wrong about that and it is a problem we here at the General Assembly have been trying to fix this for for multiple years and the senator from Alexandria did a lot of

[07:00:53] that work we've had multiple studies we've had collaboration between state agencies we've had lots of discussions I took over those discussions once he left and we now have what I think is a really meaningful bill so I'll just real quickly go through it. The conference report incorporates feedback from ABC, OAG, public health advocates, and folks who are in the industry. The key components of the report are the following. One is it establishes a self-funding underage enforcement program at Virginia ABC. ABC will administer a retail tobacco license for all retailers that sell tobacco or vape products. These license fees are

[07:01:31] paid by retailers, will fund the enforcement of the under 21 tobacco law, and through an MOU enforcement of the OAG's vapor product directory. Language in this in this bill strengthens enforcement provisions for OAG's liquid nicotine vapor product directory, ensuring that illegal products are not on the shelves. The bill closes a series of loopholes in the law to ensure that we're bringing all retailers that sell tobacco and vape products under one license so that we have a known universe of retail locations to regulate and inspect. One of the things that I found fascinating is, do you know the number of vape stores that are actually registered with the Department of Taxation?

[07:02:10] The answer is 52. There's 52 of those darn things on the Staples Mill Corridor. Okay, we have language and enabling collaboration between ABC and OAG on regulation enforcement of liquid nicotine vapor products. Compromises in this bill ensure that retail locations like convenience stores that have an existing ABC license for alcohol can pay a lower fee than the vape shops that are not currently licensed with ABC. This bill is about closing loopholes clarifying the law to protect against unregulated sales of vape products without clear licensure requirements and strong enforcement. We've had a lot of loopholes

[07:02:49] and so this is a bill that is going to do good things. Vote yes. The question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report on house bill 308 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senate senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role ayes 37 noes 2. ayes 37 noes 2. the senate adopts the conference committee report on house bill 308

[07:03:26] page 9 has bill 361 the senior senator senator from loudon thank you madam president madam president i move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor okay madam president this is the um the i would call it a cleanup bill for um earned sentence credits it just says other times that you are incarcerated on those charges you get credit for them so time on appeal um things like that it does have its late enactment clause until July 1, 2028. So it's essentially the

version that came out of Senate Finance, Madam President. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report

[07:04:04] on House Bill 361? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report page 11 has bill 433 the senior senator

[07:04:37] senator from Loudoun madam president I would defer my time to the senator from Eastern Henrico my president I think she's actually on this conference committee report and I am not the senator from Eastern Henrico thank you so much madam president I move that we adopt the conference committee report in speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you. Madam President, House Bill 433 is regarding the recommended uniform screening panel. Madam President, this panel is managed by Health Resources and Services Administration and it currently includes over 35 conditions

[07:05:12] that newborns are screened for. But this bill establishes a process for considering the addition of disorders of the Commonwealth screening program that are not currently on the recommended uniform screening panel and we did add in language in this conference report that it is subject to funding the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House bill 433 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote

[07:05:50] the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 13 has bill 590. Senator, senior senator from Prince William, will you advance the bill? Thank you, Madam President. Can we pass that by temporarily? Without objection, House Bill 590 goes by

[07:06:18] temporarily. Page 15 has bill 820. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President this is the second out of three times you are going to vote for the most impactful housing supply bill of the session so please

[07:06:48] vote yes. The question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee Report for House Bill 820. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate adopts

[07:07:28] the Conference Committee Report for House Bill 820. Page 18, House Bill 969. The senator from Eastern Prince William thank you madam president madam president I said we adopt a conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president the bill was made into a work group and the conference report says that from that work group they must develop policy and legislative recommendations to address firearm violence including mass shootings domestic violence suicides and homicides

[07:08:06] and ways and legislative proposals in order to prevent these incidents from happening I ask again that we adopt the conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 969 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no

are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The senate adopts

[07:08:43] the conference committee report. Page 19 has bill 1022. The senator from Western Fairfax. Madam president I move that we adopt the conference committee report for HB 1022. Madam president this was the click to cancel subscription bill if you will that we had heard on this side the house version and our conference committee report was very

[07:09:18] similar to what I had introduced here it did work with some of the stakeholders to make a few updates so now it includes a provision to make it easier for small print newspapers to comply and it includes the change to specify that offers that were initiated in person for subscriptions must have a simple electronic method for cancellation. Finally we had also put a good faith clause at the end of this original code section and what what we had tried to do

[07:09:56] with that was basically say that any unintentional violations of this would not fall into the category of breaking the law and what we did not know at the time and have subsequently learned is that that good faith language was a completely new part and new language used in the code and the entire code already deals with unintentional violations as a whole so it was

[07:10:33] duplicitous and i hope that we will accept this the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for house bill 1022 all in favor of that motion will record their votes i those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 20

[07:11:13] has bill 1092. The senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. I move adoption of the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you so much. Madam President, House Bill 1092 is the same as Senate Bill 288 that passed out of this body regarding heat protections for individuals working in outdoor conditions. We've made several changes in this conference report to include delaying the adoption and development and enforcement of any standards until 2028.

[07:11:46] We also remove the private right of action. We remove specificity to temperature or heat index, leaving that standard to be determined by the Safety and Healthy Codes Board. We also request that our reporting requirements are added to this legislation.

[07:12:01] And then lastly, we exempt all emergency highway construction or maintenance workers, as well as any and all emergency personnel. - The question is, shall the Senate adopt the Conference Committee Report for House Bill 1092?

[07:12:18] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[07:12:38] Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 21, House Bill 1207. The senator from Northern Fairfax.

[07:12:56] Thank you, Madam President. I move we adopt the conference report. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is paid family and medical leave. we have found consensus

between the House and the Senate that will create a paid family and medical leave insurance program.

[07:13:11] It is based on the concept that we passed through the Senate. However, we made a couple of changes that are technical in nature, dealing with the dates of when the payments would begin.

[07:13:26] And I would like to clarify for everybody that the definition of employer through this program excludes the Commonwealth employees. However, at the same time that the program will go live for the public, the Commonwealth will be required to have the same or greater benefits for all members who are working for the Commonwealth.

[07:13:52] This again will allow people to have 12 weeks off after paying for an insurance premium each month. And if you make $50,000, the actuarial studies have shown that it would be about the cost of a cup of coffee, around $5 a week.

[07:14:07] If you have 10 or fewer employees, the employer does not have to pay into the fund. And self-employed individuals would be able to opt in as well. This will help people who need to take time away and not lose their shirts.

[07:14:27] And I move that we adopt the conference report. Senator from Hanover. Madam President, would the Senator yield for a question? Will the Senator yield? Madam President, I yield. Senator from Hanover. I'd ask the Senator, does that mean that, based on your statement, that employers with 10 or less employees, the employees will continue to be required to pay?

[07:14:52] Senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, for companies that have 10 or fewer employees, the employees would pay into the fund. If they are self-employed, they can opt in. Madam President, speaking to the measure.

[07:15:07] Senator has the floor. Madam President, this is a measure we've talked about a lot during this session. And I think it's, as I articulated before, it's one where there's a very different view of opinion. This is going to require employees, all employees, even if you work for a very small business, business one or two people to have to pay into this tax and madam president i appreciate the statement that the commonwealth will have to bring its standards up but the commonwealth

[07:15:40] should have to be enrolled in the same program that we're requiring of all employees across the virginia madam president it is not because people aren't good-natured it is a question of whether employees should be able to make their own decisions should they be able to decide to buy insurance or should they be required by the government to have to purchase it this money will come out of their paychecks they will make less money as a result of this program senator from

[07:16:18] fairfax thank you madam president i just want to remind the body that in every other developed country in the world the united states is the only one that doesn't have a paid maternity leave program we know that people are delaying starting a family because they can't afford to to take the time off that their jobs do not allow them to care for themselves and their others and their loved ones when the best times or the worst times happen this will bring us in line not only with

[07:16:54] the rest of the country but 14 other states and the district of columbia already have successful programs and what they're finding is that it is increasing employee retention there's a better quality of of work going on in those states because they know that they're gonna have the ability to care for themselves

if they need to and surprisingly enough you don't see a vast number of people taking the leave these are these are and this is an insurance program

[07:17:26] it allows people like my family would have appreciated back in 1997 when my daughter was in the nick unit for two months and i was 20 miles away with a toddler and my husband was working because we were working paycheck to paycheck we did not have the flexibility for him to stay at home to help out. This is going to help families and it is an extraordinarily popular policy and I look forward to seeing my colleagues voting yes on this. The question is, shall the Senate adopt

[07:18:03] the conference committee report for House Bill 1207? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts a conference committee report for

[07:18:31] House Bill 1207. Page 23, House Bill 1278. The senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this was the bill that basically said that school boards have to provide important

[07:19:06] documents in languages that parents understand native languages which was federal guidance for many many years until very different very recently what we ended up doing at the end of the day is adopting the house version because of some the budget constraints and what that basically did in the difference between the Senate version and the House version was that we removed the sections

[07:19:41] of the bill that required the Department of Education to develop guidance and designate a staff member to provide technical assistance to schools so uh hopefully we can try to do that next year when there is more money available but that is it thank you the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for house bill 1278 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[07:20:13] to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 15. Ayes 23, noes 15. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 1278. Page 23, House Bill 1279. The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move the adoption of the

[07:20:50] conference report. Speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The conference committee reported on this bill regarding housing and our nonprofit organizations included all the Senate 11 or 12 amendments, plus two additional ones, a delayed enactment of one year, plus a provision that would not allow current applications.

[07:21:13] So if you have a current application in utilizing this, they would not be able to utilize it. And so those are the amendments in the conference report and appreciate its passage. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 1279?

[07:21:30] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk?

[07:21:48] Duran. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 16. Ayes 23, noes 16. The Senate adopts the conference committee report for House Bill 1279. Page 26 has bill 1439 the senior senator from Henrico

thank you madam president matter president i move that the that we accept the conference report and speaking to that senator has the floor thank you madam president the report makes changes uh that strengthen strengthens the overall

[07:22:28] consumer protections um in the in the bill by sending uh more written or setting adding more written transparency between solar installation companies and consumer yeah and resources that the bill properly Lord ensures that the bill properly this

[07:22:58] is bad know the way this is written but madam president this the bill sorry let's throw that away the bill is focused on consumer protections for solar for solar contracts and making sure that the stakeholders including the office of the Attorney General the individuals that are actually selling that the solar panels all have an opportunity to make their voices heard and so that's what the conference does and I hope we will act favorably upon it and I'll charge

[07:23:37] this bill with my writing the question is shall the Senate can adopt the conference committee report for House bill 1439 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 36 noes 3 ayes 36 noes 3 the Senate adopts the

[07:24:11] conference committee report on page 26 has bill 1464 the senator from northern Fairfax thank you madam president I move that the Senate concur with the conference report and speaking to the measure senator has the floor thank you madam president um this is dealing with the way that sexual assault violent criminal justice system reimbursements for medical treatment occur. Currently this would eliminate the requirement that the survivors of sexual assault

[07:24:50] report their attacks to the criminal justice system in order for the medical treatment to be reimbursed. This is a crucial step in forward in lowering barriers for the care of Virginia survivors and it builds on the work that that we've been doing for a number of years, uh, for the forensic nursing workforce. Um, I, uh, hope that we will pass this bill. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 1464? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators

[07:25:27] ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 27 has bill 1482. The Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move that the Senate agree to the conference committee report and speaking to that

[07:26:04] motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. House bill 1482 is the companion to Senate bill 352 which is the facial covering in law enforcement what we have done in the conference report is removed the private right of action along with adding a section requiring that officers in the performance of their duty shall visibly display their badge number insignia bearing which law enforcement officers or law enforcement agency they're with and their name along with other distinctions so that they're identifiable.

[07:26:42] With that explanation, I renew my motion that we adopt the conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 1482? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[07:26:57] Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Senate bills. Page 29, Senate Bill 2. Senator from

[07:27:32] Northern Fairfax. Thank You Madam President. This is the paid family and medical leave again. We just discussed this bill. Happy to have more conversations if people want to hear about why it's such a great idea to give people the grace to pay into an insurance program that will give them the ability to take up to 12 weeks off when they bring a baby into the world or caring for themselves or a loved one again this is something that is done all over the world and in 14 other states in

[07:28:05] the district of columbia and i move the passage of the bill the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for senate bill two all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[07:28:25] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 30, Senate Bill 81. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. I move that we accept the conference report and speaking of the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, President. This is the cognate to my capitulation on my parkway bill we passed with a pretty truly healthy vote

[07:29:00] about three hours ago again this is the one that allows local and state law enforcement to conduct traffic enforcement operations on a very small segment of road with no speed cameras that's the bill does the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate bill 81 all in favor of that motion will record their votes I those opposed no are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[07:29:31] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 29, noes 10. Ayes 29, noes 10. The Senate adopts a conference committee report. Page 30, Senate Bill 115. Senator from Western Fairfax. I move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[07:29:56] This is the repeal of the Blanket Concealed Carry Reciprocity Bill. We've gone back and forth with the House on whether the OAG's office or the Virginia State Police should decide which permits are okay from other states and are similar to our requirements here.

[07:30:20] And where we have finally ended up is that the OAG will make the decision and the Virginia police will make the list publicly available. So again, I move that we adopt the report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 115?

[07:30:41] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll.

[07:30:59] Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the Conference Committee report. Page 31, Senate Bill 129. Senator from Eastern Fairfax, will you move?

[07:31:21] By temporarily. Madam President, I ask this to go by temporarily. Without objection, Senate Bill 129 goes by temporarily. page 37 Senate bill 288 senator from Eastern Henrico thank you so much madam president I move adoption of the conference report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president this is the same as House bill 1092 which we passed moments ago

regarding heat stress and product providing protections for workers and outdoor conditions and so with that I

[07:31:57] hope we can move this forward the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate bill 288. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 39, Senate bill 352. Senator from Central

[07:32:36] Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Senate agreed to the conference report and speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this is the facial covering in law enforcement, which we just talked about a couple minutes ago. And with that explanation, along with the fact that we removed the private right of action and ensure that law enforcement will have to have visibility in their badges and information, I renew my motion that we adopt the conference report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for senate bill 352 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[07:33:14] to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 21 noes 18 ayes 21 noes 18 the senate adopts the conference committee report page 40 senate bill 382 the senator from eastern fairfax uh thank you madam president i would move we adopt the conference committee report and speak the motion senator has the floor thank you madam president ladies and gentlemen senate this is the cognate for the bill we've already passed

[07:33:51] i believe that creates the standardized permitting program for solar installations on people's homes I believe we already passed the House cognate to this by Delegate Hernandez, and this just had some final technical amendments to it, is my recollection. Nothing substantive.

[07:34:15] The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 382? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll it's 22 no 17 eyes 22 no 17 the Senate adopts the

[07:34:52] conference committee report page 41 Senate bill 388 the senior senator from Prince William move the adoption of the conference committee report begin to the motion senator has the floor thank you madam president this is the identical now to the bill we just passed the house version of this is regarding nonprofits and housing again just reiterate we adopted all 1112 Senate amendments plus the two additional amendments which is one a one-year delayed enactment and then the provision that entities that are currently within

[07:35:29] the process cannot utilize the new sections of law and move its adoption the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate bill 388 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed, no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, no 17.

[07:36:00] Ayes 21, no 17. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 42, Senate Bill 490. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President, Madam President, I move we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam

president members of the body this is the third time out of three we will vote for the most impactful housing supply bill of the session and if we can give a delegate from Fairfax 39 votes

[07:36:29] I'd hope you'd give one of your own 39 votes thank you very much the question is the question is shall the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference Committee Report for Senate Bill 490. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the

[07:37:03] senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The Senate adopts the conference committee report on the most historic bill on housing.

[07:37:39] Page 43, Senate Bill 493. Senator from Western Fairfax. Madam President, I move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to it. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this is once again the click to cancel a subscription bill.

[07:37:57] And having previously explained the differences, I hope we can adopt this committee report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 493? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[07:38:12] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0.

[07:38:29] Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 48, Senate Bill 620. Senator from western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, I would share more Virginia vaping trivia with you, but we all know vaping is bad for kids, so I just move we adopt the conference report.

[07:38:59] The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 620? All in favor of that motion will record their votes high. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 37 noes 2. ayes 37 noes 2 the senate adopts the conference

[07:39:28] committee report page 52 senate bill 685. senator from western fairfax uh madam president i move that we adopt the conference committee report speaking to it senator has the floor madam president this is uh the bill that we just passed the house version about providing uh parents and students access to uh communications and materials in their native language and i hope uh you will adopt this report again the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report

[07:40:04] for senate bill 685. all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 25 nose 14. ayes 25 nose 14. the senate adopts the conference committee report page 53 senate bill 756. the senator from eastern fairfax move we adopt the conference committee report speaking of that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president

[07:40:44] Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, this is the bill about the entertainment complex in Northern Virginia. We made some changes to our bill, or the center from Charlottesville proposed some

changes to the bill to broaden the area in the county that it could happen in hopes that the county would look more favorably upon it.

[07:41:05] That didn't happen. So the bill in front of you reverts to the languages introduced, which is a 1.5 million square foot mixed-use complex in a certain area near the silver line in Tyson's Corner the the bill basically expands the bill if you look at the enactment clause that's really where the meat of the bill is it basically creates a two-phase structure first the MEI approval Commission can authorize a temporary gaming establishment with up to 150,000 square foot gaming floor with the revenue of that going directly to the school of the locality the the local

[07:41:43] piece of the revenue going to the school of locality where it's located secondly once it's operating the county needs to select a permanent preferred operator obtain general assembly approval and pass a local referendum before permanent license can be issued by the lottery board consistent with the existing system if that happens and locality approves it then the different revenue formula kicks in where the money is split 50/50 between the state and the locality with that money again the local money going solely to the school system for that locality the bill also makes some conforming changes of city locality throughout the bill but basically it's designed to incentivize

[07:42:22] the locality to cooperate and work on coming up with a proposal in this process because of the revenue split that's what the bill does happy to answer any questions. It does not affect any of the localities other than Fairfax County.

[07:42:39] That's what it does. The Senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. I would urge my colleagues to vote against this. This is vastly different than what went through the committee process giving MEI now the ability to just put a casino temporarily in the middle of Tyson's Corner, which is the economic

[07:43:13] engine of not only Fairfax County, but the entire Commonwealth of Virginia. I can let you know, this is extraordinarily unpopular. Over the past week, I've gotten nearly 800 messages from my constituents. My county supervisors have their hair on fire because this casino was on the agenda to say, no, the county doesn't want it. And when we, in 2020, created the opportunity for a gaming

[07:43:52] facility in the Commonwealth, the agreement was, one, it would be an economically depressed area. That does not hold true to Fairfax County. Secondly, the locality would come to the Commonwealth and request the authority. That did not happen. In fact, the locality made it clear that they do not want this the way it has been done. And thirdly, the bill that passed through

[07:44:26] here took off the requirement that it be in Tyson's corner, which everybody voted for. So what we are doing here, just be very, very clear, if you would like one of us to bring in a piece of legislation that puts something extraordinarily unpopular in your community, this is opening the door to that.

[07:44:56] This is not the process that we have agreed upon in the Commonwealth where we are collaboratively working to make Virginia better. We all worked hard to be in these seats here to represent our communities and this is something

[07:45:28] that a community that gives and gives and gives to the Commonwealth doesn't wish to have and I could say a lot more I think that this is coming up in you know I haven't even had a chance to read this yet and I bet nobody else in this room has read the whole thing this is not the way we do public policy and it's very

[07:46:02] disappointing to me I would ask you all to vote no this is not the way we make major policy decisions that affect a specific group in the Commonwealth and just to make it 100% clear the people who live in my community and the people who live in all of northern Fairfax County the people who live in central Fairfax County the localities have already passed ordinances they have

[07:46:37] passed resolutions they have passed sent letters in saying this is not what they want. The town of Herndon, Reston, McLean, Great Falls, Tyson's Association, the town of Vienna, the Wolf Trap Association. The HOAs and communities in this vicinity are in extraordinarily strong opposition of this, especially they're gonna be really upset when they see what

[07:47:13] happens if this if this proposal passes and I ask you as your colleagues to think about what you're doing. The Senator from Arlington. Thank You Madam President. I rise to speak in opposition to the conference report. Senator has the floor. Thank You Madam President. Let's just be clear. We the state through this conference report is going to be telling Fairfax County that you must have a

[07:47:47] casino, no referendum, but at least for five years, we the state will say, Fairfax, forget about your land use planning, forget about developing your sector plan, forget about all the things that our state constitution directs the localities to do, all of their zoning authority, all of the things they're responsible for planning for. All that goes out the window simply because some members,

[07:48:21] I hope this doesn't pass, but simply because some lawmakers believe this is a good idea. And we've had enormous local opposition to this. And to what cause? If this is about raising money for the state, there are other ways we can do this. There are ways we can do this that doesn't trample on the rights of local government. There are ways we can do this that doesn't create addictive behavior. There are ways we can do this that respect our neighborhoods, the safety of our

[07:49:00] neighborhoods, the nice ambiance that we want for all the kids and the shoppers and all the tourists that come to northern Virginia. This is an incredibly bad idea on lots of levels from a public policy level, from a land use level, from trampling on the rights of local governments to saying to your localities, we don't care about your neighborhood. You don't have the right to have input on what your neighborhood looks like, on the kind of functions that are in your neighborhood, or how your whole locality is going to work with transportation, with public safety.

[07:49:37] I really do hope it is the will of the body to defeat this conference report. Thank you. The senator from Lynchburg. Oh my goodness, Madam President, I rise to speak to this bill. Senator has the floor.

[07:49:53] I had not planned to speak, but then when I heard the two senators, the senator from Northern Fairfax and the other senator from Fairfax, talk about Arlington, excuse me, what this body is about to do to them that their residents don't want. After what y'all have done to our five congressional districts.

[07:50:12] An illegal gerrymandering of our congressional districts taking away four of our congressional seats and running five through Fairfax. Do you think somebody in Augusta wants to be represented in Congress by somebody from Fairfax? And you have the gall to talk about us passing a bill to put a casino in Fairfax and we've got four or five in the rest of the Commonwealth.

[07:50:36] You think your people don't want a casino? Do you think our people want to have their Second Amendment rights taken away by this legislature, this session? No, they don't. You think our schools and our cities and our counties now want to be governed by collective bargaining?

[07:50:54] No, they don't. You talk about your rights being trampled in one General Assembly. It's been this one. And if you get a casino in Fairfax, oh my goodness. Senator from Central Fairfax.

[07:51:13] thank you madam president i rise to speak on the uh opposing this um senator has the floor uh thank you madam president throughout the whole time this bill was in the floor i did not speak about it i didn't you know express my opinion on it because we were told this was going to get to a voter referendum uh that the voters of the county will get to choose what this looks like um now in the last 20 minutes i got in a lot of folks who texted me and i thought that because i was doing a great job this session turns out they also received a you know link with uh

[07:51:49] what the uh what the substitute or what the conference version is going to be and this this really just points out that there's going to be an mei commission that will approve a temporary casino in fairfax county that can operate up to five years it then requires that that same mei approved that locality shall issue all applicable permits by rights and declares that the enactment shall supersede all other applicable provisions of the law functionally stripping local boards and

[07:52:23] neighbors of their usual land use tools for the temporary facility now i carried a lot of bills where localities were upset at me this whole session and the last two sessions for me trying to take away their local authority their land use authority this is exactly what this bill does at the end of it this bill all it does is it just does not do what the original intent was was to provide the localities with the referendum so that the people could choose what they wanted now what ended up happening between the what was what went out of this body to what is now right

[07:52:57] now is that localities realize this is not a great idea they there was a survey that was done more than 70 percent of localities did not want this uh my constituents did not want this uh and turns out the way this is written with the details of where this has to be puts the specific casino in a location uh near two miles away from a church two miles away from a mosque two miles away from a synagogue you name it from neighborhoods uh that i've seen where it's a family-friendly neighborhood

[07:53:33] uh for those reasons and so many other things i i simply um had to say something today around this because this is not what I thought we were going to have on the floor. And mind you, I was already voting against any type of referendum around this, but chose not to speak in the past.

[07:53:49] So I ask my colleagues around here, when you're talking about an MEI commission, you know, that's the same thing we could use to put other things across the whole Commonwealth, where it doesn't have to go through the voters, where it doesn't have to go through a referendum. This is just something that I have not thought about in the past either.

[07:54:09] So I ask that you all vote against this, and with that, Madam President, I renew, you know, that hopefully folks vote against this. The Senator from Isle of Wight. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking of the conference report.

[07:54:26] The Senator has the floor. I did not plan on speaking on this, but I'm going to talk about a little history of the Commonwealth for a moment, a little bit before I was ever in this body. Hampton Roads didn't have a transportation lockbox on our transportation fund until 2013, okay?

[07:54:42] Before that, the roads paved to gold on the way up to 95 to Northern Virginia are looking just fine. We're still catching up, and we're probably 25 to 30 years behind Hampton Roads. I looked online. There are 18 schools currently under construction in Fairfax County.

[07:54:59] Meanwhile, Churchill Elementary School built in 1958 in Portsmouth. My schools in Isle of Wight, Suffolk, Franklin, and beyond, all the way up to Brunswick, we have schools that are built in the 30s and the 40s. They weren't temporaries in this bill, first of all. second of all school infrastructure funds is one of the number one reasons i'm supporting this because there are parts of this commonwealth that you all can't imagine the state of our schools and the state of our roads so with the word temporary there will still be an opportunity to send this to the voters so while you have hallways and schools that are under construction

[07:55:35] we're still hoping we are able to build schools and other parts of the state so let's not forget that. Thank you, Madam President. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. No one else desires to speak, speaking to the bill. Senator, you have the floor. Wait, there's someone who does want to speak now. Senator from Western Fairfax. Sorry, Madam President, thank you. I rise to ask the patron of the bill some questions.

[07:56:05] Will the senator yield? I'll yield. Senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I'd like to ask the patron if he can tell us what exactly will be the role of local government while this temporary casino location etc is is opened what their role is in that process senator from Eastern Fairfax well the first of all the the way that the land use is currently set at that

[07:56:41] area of Tyson's Corner this would be a by right use already the only thing that is not allowed under current law is a gaming establishment which is what this enactment clause takes care of after that the county would have to issue permits once that's done they'd have to put out an RFP to try to determine a preferred licensee for a permanent license they then have to negotiate what that permanent what that permanent gaming establishment would look like consistent with the law which requires a 1.5 million square foot mixed-use

[07:57:18] facility containing not just a gaming establishment but a conference center which we don't have in Fairfax County which is larger than eight states would also have to include an entertainment venue hotels other things the details of all that would have to be worked out and proposed those matters would then have to be figured out by local ordinance a referendum authorized and once all that stuff is done and locality's figured out their preferred vendor the location all those details then it would come back here for us to vote again then it would go on the ballot for the voters to approve for a permanent license which if

[07:57:55] approved would be issued by the lottery board senator from Western Fairfax thank you madam president speaking to the bill senator has the floor um madam president I have to say I think this is probably for me one of probably the hardest decisions and votes that I have taken or will be taking on this Senate floor and there have been many we deal with many consequential issues frankly I

[07:58:29] don't like the by right building in in many different areas I didn't like it with the many housing bills that we have discussed some have passed people have voted for by right because you know there are folks who feel very passionately about casinos and then there are folks who feel very passionately about high rises too close to the neighborhood that they have chosen to invest their money and raise their families in and I think those are valid concerns I have

[07:59:08] consistently supported a referendum I think it's important I think constituent voices are important but at the moment I also feel stuck between a rock and a hard place I ran for this office on the idea and goal of raising and bringing back as much money for our public schools and the many needs that they have. I have worked to

[07:59:43] realize those goals my entire adult life and right now I am looking at this compromise which says there is a temporary casino to be built by Wright in a location that can already house a business by right and if you vote against it you will be voting against millions upon millions of dollars for our school systems a school system that has 35%

[08:00:16] children who are at the free or reduced lunch and many many many more who struggle many classrooms who need resources construction is a is a need not only in Fairfax County but as we heard across the Commonwealth our teachers cannot afford to live in our locality and drive over an hour plus a day to come

[08:00:49] teach our children I cannot look at those things and and just lightly say there's no referendum so I have to vote against this I don't love where we are right now but I also know that a vote against this will be a vote against what the Fairfax County Board of Supervisors has been begging this general assembly

[08:01:18] for which is to meet our school funding requirements and the needs that they have in our schools sometimes they have done it nicely sometimes they have done it quite obtusely and I would say not very successfully however this is exactly what they have asked for. This is going to fund our public schools, directly fund our public schools in Northern Virginia. It's going to pay our teachers

[08:01:55] so that they're able to live in the communities in which they teach. It's going to provide good-paying jobs for people who cannot find elsewhere, our working families. And at the end of the day, I cannot in good conscience vote against a temporary business that will provide so much to the community and to the children of our community. So I urge my colleagues to support the bill today.

[08:02:26] Thank you. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President, speaking to the report. Senator has the floor. If no one else desires to speak. Thank you, Madam President. So ladies and gentlemen, let me, a couple things here. First of all, I was born and raised in Fairfax County. My grandparents moved to Fairfax in 1936, when it had about 30 or 35,000 people who lived there. Think about that for a second. My grandparents moved to live in a farmhouse on a dirt road in Fairfax County. My father was born and raised in Fairfax County. I went to the same preschool he did. My kids went to the same

[08:03:04] preschool I did. That's how long I've been, me and my family, been connected with that county. And so for anyone to suggest that I'm not, that I don't care about my county, that I'm not looking out for my county that I don't care about what's in the best interest of my county I would like to them to find somebody else who's in any way leading the county is more connected to it than I am long longevity live in the county 54 years I've been on this rock I've lived in that county for 51 years terms

[08:03:41] of the location I want you all to remember that last year we voted on this same location the same location language in here we voted in this chamber and we approved. The only people that didn't vote for it are the senators who are new this year. That's the same language. Number two, just so I'm clear, a gaming establishment like this is a by right use under the county's current zoning ordinance. Not because of this bill. You could do a project like this under the county's current zoning ordinance in all of Tyson's Corner, by right, because of

[08:04:20] the way the land is currently zoned. The only thing you can't do is operate a casino because that has a separate state uh approval process that's required that's what the bill takes care of number three let's talk about telling local governments what to do do we ever tell local governments what to do last time

i last time i checked we tell them what to do all the time we tell them they have to you know what run a school we tell them they actually have to have a comprehensive plan that's a mandate we tell them they have to do social services we tell

[08:04:58] them they have to have a jail we tell them they have to have constitutional officers in some cases they have to run a health system we tell them they have to do audits they have to run elections they have to emergency management we tell them they have to have a solid waste program erosion and settlement control and i could go on and on and on and on and on with what we tell local governments what to do telling what local governments what to do is nothing new about that we are a dylan rule state they can't breathe unless we tell them so now and president i also

[08:05:38] want to remind everybody Fairfax County is a big place. It's bigger than eight states in the United States of America. 1.1 million people. Mr. Chair, Madam President. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Question for the patron. Senator, will you yield? Happy to yield. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I would like to ask the patron of the bill how long it takes him to get from his house at the very southernmost portion of Fairfax County to Tyson's corner if he

[08:06:15] is driving and there's no traffic versus when there is traffic how long does it take you to get since it is the size of eight states just to clarify how far away the senator from Eastern Fairfax lives from this region senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President I would say that it takes me about 25 minutes in my car without traffic and if it's during rush hour and I want to pay about $56 round

[08:06:54] trip in tolls I can probably knock it out in about 35 minutes if I want to get there by transit from my house it probably takes me about two and a half hours round trip and I would also note that if I wanted to I could actually run the mgm casino by foot and at the current pace that i run i can make it in about 40 minutes senator has the floor to continue with thank you madam president so um as i was saying i also want to remind everybody that fairfax is a big place larger than eight states today unlike when my

[08:07:30] grandparents moved there fairfax county has seven state senators if i'm not mistaken i believe four of the seven four yeah we had a lot of congressmen too four Four of the seven senators that represent the county, I believe, are about to vote for this bill, okay, because it's a big place.

[08:07:57] Now, I want to also talk about how Fairfax County is doing economically. I just saw, and before I say that, I also want to note that while in Virginia we have put these kinds of establishments in several cities, Portsmouth, Norfolk, Danville, Petersburg, three have just been authorized in New York City.

[08:08:23] And the state, by the way, up there did it without a referendum. requiring hundred million dollar licenses for each one okay so the rest of the country is is taking a little bit different tack on this but i would just note in terms of the how fairfax is doing on february 27th the cardinal dwayne yancey wrote an article headline says new population estimates 30 times more people have moved out of fairfax county than all of rural virginia that's the

[08:08:54] the headline. That's the headline. And if you go down, it talks about how Fairfax County right now has not lost population since the 1820s. But between 2020 and 2025, 38,495 more people moved out of the county than moved in. And the only reason the county had statistical population growth is because births outnumbered deaths. So people are moving out. You also heard my

[08:09:31] colleague from Western Fairfax talk a moment ago about poverty in the county. Fairfax County is big and parts of it are different. The part I represent is very different than the parts that other senators

represent. The US-1 corridor that I represent along the I-95 corridor is very different than the rest of the county. Fairfax County has on average between 60 and 64,000 children receiving free and reduced lunch. If that was its own school system by itself

[08:10:03] It would be the fourth largest school system in all this state. Only ones larger is Loudon, Prince William, and Virginia Beach. But the number of children who live in poverty in the county is significant. And so county folks, I can get into office vacancies. We're gonna have a big debate about office vacancy statistics and how Tyson's is doing, etc.

[08:10:28] The office vacancy rate is higher than it is the national average because what's going on federally. The county needs these revenue sources. They've been asking for it. I would ask that we give them what they've been asking for, for the last 30 years.

[08:10:45] Give them an additional revenue source, and if they don't like it, the voters vote it down and this thing goes away in five years. I would ask that you vote for the bill. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 756?

[08:11:03] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 16. Ayes 22, noes 16. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Page 54, Senate Bill 777.

[08:11:35] Senator, junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we agree to the conference report on SB 777. Speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President, SB-77 is identical to House Bill 84, which is the PJM transparency bill. And having previously explained that bill, I move that we agree to the conference report. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the

[08:12:10] conference committee report for Senate Bill 777? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 24 knows 15 eyes 24 knows 15 the Senate adopts the conference committee report page 54 Senate bill 812 the senator

[08:12:49] from northern Fairfax move the conference report will the senator speak to it. Madam President this is the cognate that I carried it has gone through the Senate unanimously it deals with crime victims reimbursement for expenses we just voted on it a couple of minutes ago and I move that that it passed. The question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 8-12. All in favor of that motion will record their

[08:13:27] votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 1. Ayes 38, noes 1. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 55, Senate Bill 823. The senior senator from Henrico thank you madam president matter president move that we accept the conference report and speaking to that senator has the floor

[08:14:03] thank you madam president this is the consumer protection legislation that I spoke about a moment ago that focuses on solar energy in the amendments are amendments that our result from conversations with deep or the office of Attorney General solar energy companies and consumer

protection advocates to protect us against solar solar companies and predatory contractors and I move that we accept the conference report the question is shall the Senate adopt the

[08:14:42] conference committee report for Senate bill 823 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate adopts the

[08:15:07] conference committee report. Returning to page 12 in your calendar, House Bill 505.

[08:15:28] The senior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor.

[08:15:45] this is the same bill this is just the house version that we already passed out that is a mixture of my my bill that tried to help deal with the situation up in the town of Percival along with delegate McAuliffe spill and and marries up those two ways to try to get at address some of the situations that have been going up they are man president with that I mean we pass it the bill adopted the conference committee report the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for house bill 505 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senate

[08:16:24] senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 21 noes 18 ayes 21 noes 18 the senate adopts the conference committee report on page 13 has bill 590 the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move that we adopt the conference report and speak of that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I misspoke a few moments ago. We passed the CogDate to this

[08:17:01] about 30 minutes ago. This is the standardized solar permitting platform bill for residential solar. It's going to save people $5,000 to $8,000 per solar installation. It is a true affordability bill. Hope we can pass it. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report For House Bill 590, all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[08:17:26] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, no 17.

[08:17:42] Ayes 22, no 17. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 15, House Bill 705. The Senator from the senior Senate Senator from Loudon. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that we adopt the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Okay, Madam President, this is a bill that we adopted the House version. It's just a section one bill that directs the Board of Education on some issues related to water safety and making sure that kids are advised of them. And with that, Madam President, I move we adopt the bill, adopt the committee report.

[08:18:21] The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 705? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[08:18:37] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 31, Senate Bill 129.

[08:19:03] The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move the conference report be adopted. And speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. So

this is a little different now. I just wanted to highlight then the study. As it left, this bill left the Senate.

[08:19:21] It was in the form of a study. And through some discussions and looking at the structure, It was able to return to its original bill form with a couple of modifications I want to highlight. So it sticks to a house version, which is a 10% tax on the fantasy platforms only.

[08:19:39] So it's not any fantasy like between neighbors or any of the context like that. It's simply 10% of the existing platforms that exist that you might be familiar with where you're picking a player and it's player versus player that are betting. So it's simply right now in the code, we're probably one of the, because we're one of early states were the one of the early states that had no tax well most the states have higher tax than what's proposed here some have lower but we're right about the sweet spot at 10% and also a application fee of $50,000 plus a 2.6% fee to cover the cost for lottery to oversee this and so that's

[08:20:16] also change of changing from fantasy sports governed by VDAX over to a lottery which I think is you know the appropriate place where they have some level of sophistication to deal with these things. It's very similar to the sports betting applications in terms of similar applicants, like the Fan Duels and not to name corporate names, but there's very well known other names that you would probably recognize that do the player to player fantasy side.

[08:20:42] So I want to highlight to the body that it is in a little different form than it left, although it's similar components that it was introduced. And so this does provide a little bit more revenue to the state and sort of a modest 10% rate of which the industry has no objections to it comes out of their fees and it's something that's been worked on for quite some time so I ask the conference report be adopted. The chair recognizes the senator from orange. Thank you Madam President. Senator from Prince William rise for a question. Will the senator yield? I yield. Senator from orange. Madam President I would ask the

[08:21:18] gentleman or the senator from Prince William I can't remember but I believe when we were looking through this we put money and problem gaming is that is that correct? Senator from Prince William. Madam President I think the center for the the the question I did overlook it in my explanation so we do provide as proposed in the original bill 2.5% to problem gaming so the remainder of the 96 and a half or 97 and a half goes to the general fund but each one of these does contribute to problem gaming so thank you thank the senator for that question. Madam President, speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[08:21:57] Ladies and gentlemen of the Senate, I would just tell you this has been the work product that the senator from Prince William, myself, and Senator Eben used to work on. The last two or three years, we found out that fantasy sports, fantasy contests were paying zero. They weren't paying in anything and they were taking a huge profit home. It wasn't fair to all the other gaming institutions at all to make sure that this entity had to pay its share as well as what the senator from Prince William mentioned about problem gaming so it puts it on the same platform as everything else that we've

[08:22:36] been working on for the last couple years and I just ask everybody to support the bill. Thank you. The question is shall the Senate adopt the conference Committee report on Senate Bill 129. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to

[08:23:02] change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 26, noes 12. Ayes 26, noes 12. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 35, Senate Bill 225. Senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[08:23:38] I move the conference report pass and speak that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This bill simply reaffirms what the Senate had previously adopted. The House came over to our position. This is the Clean Energy Innovation Bank, which allows the bank to proceed without creating a separate authority. It just becomes a unit or something under the Department of Energy. It's in our budget. I hope we can adopt a bill. It's going to generate a lot of good investment in Virginia.

[08:24:05] The question is, shall the Senate adopt the Conference Committee report for Senate Bill 225? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[08:24:25] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. The Senate adopts the conference committee report.

[08:27:51] The Senate will be at ease.

[08:35:39] Await some further conference committee reports. Now is the time for us to take up points of personal privilege. The chair recognizes the senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President.

[08:35:55] Rise for a point of personal privilege. Senator will pause until everyone has had the opportunity to be seated. the senator may continue thank you madam president and members I just have a few brief remarks about this budget process I've been asked by a lot of people about what we're doing I've heard the talk

[08:36:32] that there's a budget deadlock and mad president I just wanted to be clear about what this alleged deadlock is. It's a $1.9 billion tax break for Amazon and the largest, most profitable companies in the entire world. And, Madam President, that's it. That is the whole story. The House of Delegates wants to protect a $1.9 billion annual

[08:37:05] sales and use tax exemption for the wealthiest corporations on earth. The same sales and use tax that our constituents pay. The Senate just wants to level the playing field.

[08:37:21] And, Madam President, I think it's very important that every Virginian understand that this choice is not complicated. It's a choice. Should Amazon and the data centers be exempt from paying the same sales and use tax as all other Virginians? Our constituents, our families, our small business, hell even our big businesses pay it because right now the house of delegates is protecting the data centers and the senate is protecting the people that is the choice that's the whole choice the

[08:37:58] people versus the data centers every virginian pays that sales and use tax every single one of us you pay it on your groceries on your car on the lumber to fix your house on the equipment to run your business, on the clothes you put on your children's backs.

[08:38:18] It funds our schools, our roads, our first responders. We pay it all except for one group, data centers, the massive server farms owned by Amazon and the wealthiest corporations in the history of human civilization.

[08:38:38] They pay zero. They're exempt. $1.9 billion a year gone. Every year, a gift, currently being defended by the House, handed to companies that do not need our charity.

[08:38:57] That's what this budget standoff is all about. That's the only thing it's about. I want this chamber, I want all of Virginia to hear who is on the other side of this debate. Because when the House protects this exemption, there are people they choose to leave behind.

[08:39:20] And those people are the nurses that buy scrubs for their shifts. The teachers buying classroom supplies out of their own pockets. The farmer buying equipment to feed Virginians. The small business owner buying inventory to keep our doors open.

[08:39:37] The family buying a car just to get to work. The contractor buying lumber to build Virginians' homes. The restaurant owner buying equipment to serve his community. The single mom buying a laptop for a child's homework. The plumber buying tools to fix your pipes.

[08:39:56] The veteran building his own small business from scratch. The electrician buying wire and conduit to fix our homes. The firefighter buying gear at the sporting goods store and the grocer paying tax on every item on every shelf.

[08:40:11] The dry cleaner, the mechanic, the florist, the daycare owner, and the list goes on and on. All except the data centers. Every single Virginian except the data centers.

[08:40:27] Each of these people is required to pay their taxes without question, and oftentimes with impunity. They don't have a lobbyist in the hall fighting for them. This standoff exists because the House wants to keep it that way.

[08:40:43] Make no mistake about it, Northern Virginia is the data center capital of the world. More server capacity than anywhere on this planet. These companies have consumed our power grid and we subsidize it for them, strained our natural resources and reshaped our landscape.

[08:41:02] Virginia taxpayers have been subsidizing them the entire time. And our constituents are asking, who do we work for? Madam President, in the Senate, we work for the people. And that answer is very clear.

[08:41:20] And there's a path out of this standoff. It ain't complicated. The Senate has passed a budget. It funds every Virginian's priorities. It asks the most profitable companies on earth to simply pay what the rest of us pay.

[08:41:38] And so I say to the House of Delegates, "Join us." The people of Virginia are not asking for much. They're asking to be treated the same as these companies. They're asking for a government that fights for the people, not for big tech.

[08:41:56] That shouldn't be a hard ask, Madam President. Virginia is the people, and the Senate stands with Virginia. $1.9 billion a year that should be going to our schools, our roads and our communities.

[08:42:14] We've made our choice and I hope the House will follow us. Madam President, I heard on the campaign trail that the House Democrats were running on a platform of affordability. I thought they meant affordability for Virginians, not data centers.

[08:42:30] Thank you, Madam President. - Recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach.

[08:42:46] The senator will pause. Senator from Virginia Beach. - Thank you, Madam President. I have a point of personal privilege. - Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I want to start off by thanking his body for signing the memorial resolution for my godbrother, Ron Yael Whitaker.

[08:43:06] And I just want to take this moment to share some comments about him. Many of you may not know that Ron Yael was born in Norfolk in 1979. He's the nephew of the Hall of Fame box entrepreneur, Sweet Pete Whitaker.

[08:43:23] We grew up in the same community called Young Park, Young Terrace in the St. Paul's Quadrant in Norfolk, Virginia. He graduated from Lake Taylor High School, where he was a phenomenal athlete. I'm just going to read you some of his stats right here. He learned four years as a running back, a defensive back, and return man.

[08:43:40] He scored 84 touchdowns and ran for over 6,458 yards. He was a three-time All-American and an all-time water player of the year. He played college football at the greatest university in the land, Virginia Tech, go Hokies.

[08:43:59] Where he was a three-year starter, he was rated the number three cornerback in the nation by the Sporting News and ranked the number six quarterback by Lindy's. He was a two-time Big East All-Conference player and an AP All-American. He was a founding member of what we call Defensive Back University, DBU.

[08:44:22] Ryan Whitaker was, technically he was 5'8", but you know football players always give a couple inches to themselves. So we like to say he was 5'10". He wore number two at Virginia Tech. and as a freshman in college he was the type of leader that you looked up to he was the type of leader that demanded respect he knew the playbook ends and out he demanded the most from us any problems had he made sure we were accountable in fact ron year was the type of person where you wanted to have him in your life because not only did he have this big impressionable smile he had

[08:45:00] a big heart but he ain't take no mess from anyone he was a feisty defensive back but he played the game with passion raya was raya meant so much to so many people so many people he is norfolk through and through my mother his godmother he raya was uh one of the the pride one of like you know uh the pride of her eye and raya was the type of person where he always can make you laugh he was

[08:45:39] hilarious he was the type of guy he will walk into a room and didn't know you and just start talking to you and next thing you know both of y'all are laughing like so hard um raya would go on to play for the vikings the detroit lions when nfl went to europe he made all nfl europe team he played in canada as well then he retired he coached in in minnesota he stayed in minnesota once he played for the vikings and um he died unexpectedly at a very young age i think one of

[08:46:16] the hardest things about losing not only like your brother but losing someone where they come from the same community where opportunities don't always flow and opportunities aren't always available and knowing that you gotta like persevere over all adversity and still manage to keep a smile on your face. Still manage to be respectful to your peers. Still manage to carry yourself with decency and honor. That's the type of person my year was. And as a high school coach in Minnesota,

[08:46:55] I'm sure he shared those with his players. If that wasn't hard enough already, I want to talk about, if you just indulge me, my other good friend who played at Kellum High School in the city of Virginia Beach. And this guy was like five, six. He had the biggest calf muscles ever.

[08:47:23] I was like 6'3", 160 pounds, skinny kid in high school. He was short, stocky, strong guy by the name of Delmas Coley. He was 42 years old. Delmas, myself, Brandon Pace, Barry Drakeford, they all went to Kellum. I went to First Colonial. This is high school. But we all made all Tidewater in all state as players and brandon and i end up going to virginia tech delmas end up going to william and mary but let me tell you his stats in high school because nobody wanted to tackle him

[08:47:58] like he was he was just a monster running back but during his season he was again five foot eight he rushed for over 2238 yards and 26 touchdowns including this guy had 340 yards in one game like nobody wanted to tackle delmas but he had an incredible incredible smile and very humble and quiet dude as well, native of Virginia Beach, and unfortunately, a family member of his found him passed away last weekend. Now, these two families didn't know each other per se because Delma's

[08:48:37] family ended up moving to Carolina, but nonetheless, both their funerals are tomorrow, and so I want to, I understand we have a long day today. Hopefully, we have a brief tomorrow. I'm going to be a bit late tomorrow um but i want to thank y'all in advance for understanding um where i'll be tomorrow and knowing that when i show up in these chambers like the reality of it is i love being around

[08:49:11] like members of the senate because we do treat each other respect regardless of what the outside thinks how we act in here we do have some sense of decorum and civility and i appreciate that And I appreciate every last one of y'all, even though sometimes members can get on my nerves.

[08:49:33] But I'm sure I get on y'all nerves as well. So it goes both ways, it goes both ways. But I wanna say tomorrow, if you don't see me smile, if you don't see me at my highest, I know y'all gonna help pick up my spirits tomorrow as well.

[08:49:52] And I just wanna thank y'all in advance for not only your thoughts and text messages from me and my family, but also thank y'all in advance for You know, it's been a long session. We did a lot of work. But for the respect we have for each other when we see each other throughout the General Assembly on this campus ground and in this building, I really do appreciate that, and I need that, and I thank you all for that.

[08:50:18] Thank you, Madam President. The Senator from Norfolk. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for a point of personal privilege.

[08:50:37] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I would like to take a moment to recognize the Norview High School varsity basketball team in my district for an incredible achievement. Yesterday, the team captured the VHSL Class 5 state championship with a thrilling victory over Virginia Beach's Green Run High School.

[08:51:08] With the game tied at less than five seconds remaining, I know we have senators that represent Virginia Beach here, womp womp. With the game tied at less than five seconds remaining, Will Adams hit a game-winning three-point shot, sealing a 58-55 victory and bringing the state title home.

[08:51:27] This championship reflects not only the remarkable athletic talent but also the discipline, teamwork, determination demonstrated by these young men throughout the season. Their accomplishment is a source of great pride for their school, their families, and the entire community. Madam Madam President, I ask that the Senate join me in congratulating these players, coaches, and supporters of the Norview High School varsity basketball team in Norfolk on this outstanding achievement.

[08:52:04] The chair recognizes the Senator. Sorry I have one more point of personal privilege. Senator may continue. Thank you. This one is on a little bit more of a somber note Madam President. Lieutenant Colonel Brandon A. Shaw was tragically passed yesterday in the shooting at Old Dominion University, my alma mater.

[08:52:32] He is a native of Virginia, an alumnus and commissionee of ODU, and a professor of military science at ODU's Army Reserve Officers' Training Corps, the ROTC. Brandon enlisted into the Army in 2003 as an aviation operations specialist.

[08:52:55] While enlisted, he obtained the rank of sergeant before transitioning. On completing his enlisted service, which included service in the active duty Army, Army Reserves, the Virginia Army National Guard, Brandon graduated from Old Dominion University with a Bachelor of Science in Sociology and a Military Science minor.

[08:53:19] He then went on to earn his MBA from the University of Georgia and an MS in engineering management from the University of Kansas. During Brandon's military service, he earned many awards, including the Senior Army Aviator Badge, the Combat Action Badge, Parachutist Badge, and the Air Assault Badge.

[08:53:45] In addition, Brandon has two Bronze Star Awards, a Defense Meritorious Service Medal, two Meritorious Service Medals, Air Medal with Valor, Joint Service Commendation Medal, Army Commendation Medal, of which he has three, and Joint Service Achievement Medal, and three Army Achievement Medals, and numerous Campaign and Unit Awards.

[08:54:14] Let us all keep Brandon and his family in our thoughts and prayers, and when we adjourn today, I move that we adjourn in honor and memory of Lieutenant Colonel Brandon A. Shaw, who was taken from us way too soon.

[08:54:31] Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator. The Chair recognizes the Senator from TASWELL. Thank you, Madam President.

[08:54:46] Rise for point of personal privilege. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, today, history has been made yet again. A couple of hours ago, right down the street here at the VCU Segal Center, the senator from Shenandoah, my seatmate, and myself both had high school that played for the state championship, Central Woodstock High School in the center from Shenandoah's district, and Graham High School, which is a high school in my district.

[08:55:17] And I am pleased to announce, Madam President, that Graham High School is the 2A Boys State Championship with a score, ending score of 65 to 58. And I give my condolences to my seatmate. Thank you, Senator.

[08:55:36] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. And this is maybe more of a reminder and maybe also an admission of guilt at the same time, which is to say that our practices do not include the use of names, specific company names or any other thing as such during our debate around issues.

[08:56:02] So just as a reminder, I did as well in presenting one bill, mentioned one company and then quickly corrected it, but just as a reminder, we try not to pinpoint as passionate as we might be around issues specific company names or things but rather focusing on the policy itself so just as a reminder I've slipped today and so wanted to call that out as we sort of maybe get a little tired maybe forget some of our custom uses and practices in the Senate and so I think the body thank you my

[08:56:33] president thank you senator the senator from Portsmouth thank you madam president madam president I rise on a point of personal privilege the senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Yesterday, the other body announced that the budget conference had failed to deliver a compromise. The press heard earlier that we are still actively working to get a budget, and we will. Ultimately, we will get a biennial

[08:57:08] budget for Virginia, and we will have it long before June 30th. However, let me be crystal clear. I have provided clarity about our objectives. Our objective has always been to invest in making life more affordable for Virginians by producing a balanced budget that invests in education, health care, and other items that promote affordability.

[08:57:35] To make these investments, we need revenue, growth that supports our ongoing spending. Our responsibility to hard work in Virginia is a budget that doesn't burden them by paying more for the collective services that we all need.

[08:57:55] The Senate has always been the body to look beyond a two-year budget cycle. House election, one-term governors, or any short-term gimmicks to get a budget over the finish line. Now, let's start with the elephant in the room.

[08:58:14] Data centers. I voted for the original data center. Sales and use tax in 2008. The goal was to incentivize an industry to locate here and create jobs. I would never have imagined my phone being able to create my Twitter theme memes, harnessing the internet in so many other ways.

[08:58:39] Those early data centers transformed overnight and Northern Virginia became the data center alley of the world. They're also purchasing computer equipment at a rate that no one in the General Assembly could even have imagined.

[08:58:55] Virginia's capacity to become the leader was not just from the sales tax freebie, but also their access to a strong fiber network supply to reliable energy, available land, and proximity to major national customers in Virginia.

[08:59:14] It all contributed to the growth that we have today and the problems that go along with it. Data centers are in Virginia because of these factors. Yesterday, I also heard that data centers create so many jobs, and yes, they create jobs, but let's be clear that those jobs are primarily in the construction phase, at the height of construction.

[08:59:42] 1,500 workers may be on the construction site of a data center. By the time a data center is operational, it may employ between 10 to 50 employees. To state it another way, to get the same economic benefit from data centers, we have to continue building them.

[09:00:01] Can we really afford to build more? Should we not be building more residential housing, commercial or advanced manufacturing? Or can we afford to allow these sales tax giveaways to continue without asking for these companies to come to the table and be better corporate partners?

[09:00:20] The data center industry is driving significant increases in energy demand that will require massive infrastructure investment to ensure the reliability of our power grid. J-Lock even noted in their 2023 report that building this infrastructure be the very difficult to achieve. If data centers continue to be built here at such a rapid rate, the challenge to maintain affordable utility rates will only worsen. Now, here's what we can deliver

[09:00:55] to our constituents from expiring tax breaks for data centers. We can invest in our workforce, k-12 education higher educations support for all modes of transportation backfilling social assist social assistance from trump's draconian cuts and providing that tax to working class yes i said it senator oberstein our investments can be made in long-term support this isn't a zero-sum game

[09:01:31] as we need to invest in our people and their infrastructure the world is changing with artificial intelligence and we need to prepare for what that means for an educated workforce. AI is here, absolutely, and we need to train our students and workforce. I will not back down from this and turn away to ask hard-working Virginians to shoulder more of the cost when they are being pinched at the gas pump and at stores daily. The wealthiest corporations in the world should pay

[09:02:07] their fair share just like small businesses and hard-working Virginians do every day. We will continue to work on the budget with the House and it will deliver affordability. Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for, I guess, a point of personal privilege. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. First of all, I just want to say the other day I got a little

[09:02:38] hot we were talking about assault weapons and um the internet powered by my ai powered phone um pointed out to me a few things some things i said that i just want to correct um there's some very creative people on twitter by the way there's some great pictures of me with all kinds of um creative crazy looking weapons that i never thought existed but um i did not know that it was actually legal to purchase a flamethrower who knew but apparently i said you can't buy a flamethrower

[09:03:12] Okay, well, apparently some people in here know that flamethrowers are illegal to purchase and use. So, I was wrong when I said that. I also talked about people attaching telescopes to their weapons. There's some really clever memes out there of me with weapons and telescopes, but I just want to make clear I was talking about there are things called telescopic sights or riflescopes.

[09:03:45] So I just want to make sure everybody knows I was talking about scopes, not necessarily telescopes. So anyway, the other thing I want to say is I did say it costs Virginia $720 million a year in health care expenditures for firearm injuries.

[09:04:03] I was a little inaccurate. It's actually $720 million between 2020 and 2024. So that's over a four-year period. I wanted to make sure the record was clear on that. Anyway, beyond all that, Madam President, I did want to talk about data centers a bit. Because that seems to be the topic of the day.

[09:04:21] And I think both Madam Chair and the Senator from the King George, King George, the Northern Neck, talked a bit about it. And, you know, this data center thing is, you know, it's obviously, it's a good thing.

[09:04:43] It's been wonderful for our Commonwealth, but as with many good things, it also comes with some other things that we have to cope with. And, you know, Virginia now has transformed into the largest data center group. We have the largest grouping of data centers in the entire world. Not America, but the entire world.

[09:05:02] When's the last time, you know, Virginia led the world, not just our country, but the world in something? And, you know, that's because so much of the internet traffic comes through here. And that started off because when we had AOL and MCI WorldCom and Loudoun, you know, certain infrastructure got put there, which made it very attractive.

[09:05:19] And I agree that when we initially adopted this exemption in 2010, nobody thought it would grow this big. But I think it's important to note, at least according to the data center-powered AI I checked and other people I've talked to, between 36 and 39 other states have this exemption.

[09:05:38] And there are policy reasons behind having that exemption. We don't tax equipment that goes on the floor of factories with sales taxes. That's industrial equipment. We don't tax that. And I think many states have viewed the chips that go in these data centers as being the equivalent of industrial equipment in today's modern economy, which is why almost every other state in America has adopted this exemption.

[09:06:02] The reason it's hitting us so hard is because we've been so successful. And so it has a big impact on us. And, you know, the amount of jobs they create is incredible.

[09:06:19] I've heard economic reports for the last three or four years at Northern Virginia, especially in the last two years, about how depressed our economy is in Northern Virginia. The only thing that has been sustaining it has been the new jobs and investments that have come from this industry.

[09:06:35] And without that, we would very likely have been in a much worse recession in Northern Virginia. And so I think it's important to note that. I also think that, you know, there's some localities that benefit greatly from this. You've heard me talk about how Loudoun County has a real estate tax rate that is 30% lower than Fairfax.

[09:06:55] And it's not 30% lower because the homes are worth that much more. It's because the data center revenue has allowed them to fund almost their entire school system with that revenue as opposed to going to taxpayers. I also just want to note that back before session started, there were dueling reports out there, narratives that were going on.

[09:07:15] There was one article that talked about, or there's one report that came out that said data centers are running up all the electric bills and there was another report that came out from I forget it's Livermore Laboratory I think in California that said that the existing rate increases were not generated by data centers they were largely generated by other sources I sent both of those reports to the State Corporation Commission and asked them if they could answer some questions for me and they wrote back to me this is our utility regulator that we asked to answer these questions and partially for us and I asked them what percentage of the recent rate increases are attributable to

[09:07:54] They wrote back to me and they said that 59% of the Phase II utility increases, because I can't use their name, were generated by inflation. On the Phase I utility, 69% of the rate increases were generated by inflation or CPI.

[09:08:13] And when I asked them to tell me to quantify how much of the rate increases were generated by data centers, this is through the last rate cases that were given, they said 80 cents per month. I have the letter, if anybody wants to read it, where they respond to me where they said this.

[09:08:28] 80 cents per month is what they've cost. Now, the big costs are coming because the big costs are coming in these big transmission projects and the other infrastructures needed to power what's coming forward because we've tapped out our existing capacity. And that is clear. And the other thing the SEC wanted to cite to me, they mentioned to me amongst the many questions I asked, is that because of the new rate class they just adopted, 85% of transmission costs that are generated by data centers will be covered by them.

[09:08:58] Okay? So 85% of those transmission costs. So, you know, we have been taking steps. they haven't been as fast as I think everybody wants to take but we've been taking so far a measured approach to deal with the you know this industry which has actually been you know sustaining our economy to some extent the number the amount of money that has been exempted is is because truly astounding and it's generated by two things one is our success the other thing is by AI has caused a lot of these centers to have to refresh their chips in existing data centers and all that increased spending on rejuvenating

[09:09:38] existing facilities has created a lot more activity which has created this exempt does this tax exempt money and so we need to be careful going forward we cannot afford to continue watching two billion dollars a year go out the window and that's what this conversation is about is to make sure that we have a careful calibrated balanced policy that creates the right incentives in the right business climate and you know that to deal with this and I think that's what doing that's what this conversations me about over the next month and I want to thank madam chair for putting this on the table because I think the

[09:10:16] conversations overdue it's time we had it and and I'm looking forward to productive discussion with the folks down the hall and the woman upstairs about it after we're done because it's it's time we had it and we just got to be careful that you know we don't chase these jobs out of Virginia because it's it's done some good things for us as well that's all i have to say right now thank you madam president the chair recognizes the senator from roanoke thank you madam president uh rise for a

[09:10:53] point of personal privilege the senator has the floor uh thank you madam president there's been a lot of discussion about cost of living i think there's been a lot of good critiques about some of the tariff policy out of washington and i think we need to make sure that we don't get lost what's happening here in the commonwealth and when we talk about the cost of living people often think about the price that shows up on a receipt but often it's much bigger than that often it's a job that never gets posted an investment that gets delayed or hours that all of a sudden disappear

[09:11:30] from an employee's opportunity there's dozens of bills this year that changed landlord-tenant law and quickly that results in a neighbor who owns a duplex deciding it's no longer affordable for them to do it and so they end up selling it to someone that has the money to have a management company operate it it's when virginia joins reggie and folks will see it on their electric bill but they'll also see it in when a refrigerated truck runs a few less routes or a few a lot less routes and it results in less job opportunities for the fellow that drove that truck it's when

[09:12:10] Virginia penalizes missing notices at restaurants and an independent restaurant ends up getting sued and soon thereafter that independent restaurant gets replaced by another coffee shop out of Seattle. It's when the mattress becomes more expensive so a blue-collar worker makes the old one last longer and his back aches just a little bit more each day.

[09:12:34] It's when higher wages are mandated on a farm, and now the data center contract that's been turned down multiple times becomes irresistible to the farmer. None of these outcomes are written on any of the bills or fiscal impact statements that crossed our desks this year, but they'll be felt by real Virginians, and I hope when this huge stack of bills comes to the governor's desk, she looks at the whole cost of living that the Virginians will have to bear.

[09:13:02] Thank you, Madam President. The chair recognizes the senator from Western, Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Rise for a brief point of personal privilege. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I want to refer you all to a Washington Post article that came out January 15th this year.

[09:13:20] Title, why your power bill is spiking faster than a nearby data center's subhead. As electricity prices climb, an unusual disconnect is emerging between what regular people pay and what data centers pay. And when you get into this report, there is a story, there is a part of here that talks about what happened in, quote, late 2023. For example, the grid operator PGM, which manages transmission from Ohio to Maryland, approved a $5 billion project to update transmission lines, partly because of data centers. In Virginia and Maryland, most of the costs of that project were borne by

[09:13:59] residential customers, even though the transmission line was not primarily for the use of people living in homes and apartments. We don't have to go back to 2023 to see that. We can go almost on a month-by-month basis right now, Madam President, of finding transmission line proposal after transmission line proposal after transmission line proposal where the upper 90 percentile of the electricity demand that is going through those transmission lines in order to justify their creation in the first place is going to data centers, not to the people. We can go back to

[09:14:39] 2014 and to Haymarket and look at the construction of a data center over there that then turned into the hybrid transmission line route where 97, more 97% of the electricity went to that data center And yet my constituents were the ones left footing the bill.

[09:14:55] I could do this ad infinitum, Madam President, again and again and again and again and again and again and again and again of transmission line proposals and transmission line projects, including current ones that are either already slated for or going to review at the SEC that are going to cut directly next to where people live or wipe out their green space altogether to benefit a multibillion.

[09:15:22] a multi-billion or a multi-trillion dollar company at the expense of everyday Virginians. What's the value of what the Senate position is fighting for? It's not just pay your fair share. It's also telling them if you want to operate here, you got to play by the same rules everyone else does.

[09:15:43] And for the last part, Madam President, when we hear that they're getting a tax break because computer chips are presumed to be for industrial use, then we should be restricting their placement only to industrially zoned areas. Now, that's a conversation that is going to have to take place via more legislation come 2027. That said, there is always something more that we can be doing to stand up for our constituents and every fight that we have on their behalf to lower their cost

[09:16:18] while telling the most profitable companies in the world you got to pay your fair share is a fight worth having thank you madam president this is the senator from lynchburg oh it's okay it's okay thank you madam president i rise for a point of personal privilege senator has the floor i am calm now no hollering no screaming i'm good it is now 7 50 on friday night the last night of

[09:16:55] the session and for the last 45 minutes we have had the best debate about data centers and there's two workers in the gallery it's the middle of the beginning of march madness i'm pretty sure that nobody's at home watching us on their apple pads right now this is a debate that should have been going on all session it is a debate that should have been done out in the public through our committees with people testifying and we were here yesterday and there were government specialists

[09:17:35] and leaders of major corporations and they're all meeting in closed off rooms. That's where the debate has been going on with two or three people and some companies and some of their government specialists. This debate should have been going on all session by us like we're having tonight with the

public and with people in the galleries and people in the committee rooms listening to this debate so it could have been written about all session so our constituents

[09:18:07] would have had the opportunity to weigh in and that is my disappointment about what we are doing now and and we really don't have much say so in what's going to happen with the data center so final vote on the budget that's it and i would have liked to have had this debate all session no screaming no hollering how about that madam president we are all impressed senator senator

[09:18:41] from hanover thank you madam president madam president i hope that there are two more bills on the desk that we're going to take up tonight apparently three more bills on the desk but madam president as we've listened to this debate tonight senator are you writing privilege senator has the floor madam president as we've listened to this discussion tonight i want to remind the body and Virginians of some of the other things that we voted on and are in the budget.

[09:19:11] We have voted on the fact that every employee, except state employees, are going to pay a tax in their paycheck. They're going to take home less in their paycheck. Madam President, we voted on a budget that says that every person that has a power bill is going to pay more for their power bill through RGGI. And Madam President, included in the budget as well is something that is going to make this debate about a billion or two billion seem like peanuts and that is collective bargaining because virginians

[09:19:50] are going to pay through the nose and if you want to talk about your real estate taxes being 30 percent less in one jurisdiction than another that is going to change pretty quickly once that collective bargaining hits so madam president it is great that we're having this debate on a Friday night but we're going to be having the debate over the next two years about the high cost that Virginians are going to be paying and it's going to come from somewhere and data center money is going to pale in comparison with the tax bills that are going

[09:20:23] up for Virginians. Conference Committee report on Senate Bill 542. The Senator from Eastern Henrico.

[09:21:09] thank you so much madam president i move adoption of the committee conference report and speaking to that motion senator has the floor madam president and members of the body this conference report is related to the legislation establishing a regulated adult use cannabis retail market here in the commonwealth the conference report finalizes several key points the conference report adopts the start date that has been included in the senate legislation to date establishing January 1, 2027 as the retail market start date and adjust necessary application timelines to align with the regulatory process. Madam President, we've set the conversion fee

[09:21:46] for existing medical operators at 10 million, landing squarely between the 5 million recommended in the House and the 15 million recommended by the Senate. Madam President, the report also adopts the House recommendation creating escalating penalties for repeat violations of illegal distribution, a class two misdemeanor for first offense, class one misdemeanor for the second, and a class six felony for a third and subsequent offense. Madam President, the report incorporates provisions along the Virginia ABC Authority to lead with enforcement related to the illicit market activity, particularly monitoring an illicit market tip line and coordinating with

[09:22:26] the Cannabis Control Authority. Madam President, the legislation requires a submission of the General Assembly to the General Assembly of a formal plan outlining coordination between ABC and the

Cannabis Control Authority, including enforcement roles and organizational responsibilities moving forward. The conference reports also shifting licensing regulation and enforcement of intoxicating hemp products from VDACs to the Cannabis Control Authority, ensuring that all cannabinoid products are regulated under one agency and subject to consistent testing safety standards and enforcement as part of the shift the report addresses known loopholes that allow

[09:23:05] intoxicating hemp products to circumvent existing thc limits helping ensure these products cannot undercut the regulated cannabis market madam president the conference report also adopts the house tax structure including a six percent state cannabis tax and optional local tax between one to three percent plus existing sales tax resulting in an overall rate generally around 12 to 16 statewide, and it requires annual reporting to support assessing the tax structure in the future.

[09:23:36] Madam President, the conference report keeps the Senate framework, dedicating 40% of revenues to early child care and education and 30% to the Cannabis Equity Reinvestment Fund. It ensures communities most impacted by prohibition benefit from the legal market. The report makes several adjustments to support small businesses and includes disproportionately impacted by prohibition, including reducing the ownership requirement for impact licensee applicants from 66% to 51%, expanding the eligibility criteria for communities disproportionately policed for marijuana offenses by extending qualifying residency back to 1999. And the conference

[09:24:16] report removes provisions that would have limited micro businesses to buying and selling only among themselves, allowing them to participate in the broader regulated market. We've also added provisions for public searchable directory of licensees enhancing reporting on equity program outcomes and data on illicit market capture to inform future policy decisions we've updated the testing labeling and product registration standards to better ensure cannabis products meet clear safety and quality requirements madam president this conference report reflects months

[09:24:50] of collaboration and negotiation among legislators regulators industry representatives advocates and public safety stakeholders many parties did not get everything they asked for but everyone got what they needed to legally and safely operate a marketplace this is the hallmark of a good compromise and this legislation represents a balanced path forward to responsibly regulate virginia's cannabis market with this legislation and if we adopt this conference report virginia will join more than two dozen states that have moved beyond legalization to establish a safe

[09:25:25] regulated cannabis marketplace so madam president on behalf of senator lucas senator rouse and myself i hope we can adopt the conference report the question is shall the senate adopt the conference committee report for senate bill 542 all in favor of that motion will record their votes those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[09:26:03] Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The conference committee report is adopted.

[09:26:41] Okay, on page 51, Senate Bill 661. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. thank you madam president um i move that we agree with the conference report and speaking to that bill senator has the floor thank you madam president everyone's favorite subject um this has been a a long time coming and before i start i truly want to thank um the conferees both in the house and in the senate on this piece of legislation there's not a single line in this legislation

[09:27:21] that has not been reviewed, turned over, debated, and to get to where we are today, SB 661 has enhanced regulation. It reduces the 90,000 illegal and machines in the market to 25,000 legal taxable skilled games. It sets a rate of 25% of gross profits, which generates $350 million plus in annual tax revenue which is included in both budgets the breakdown is this and includes 75 percent to the general fund 15 percent to localities six and a half

[09:27:59] percent to local lottery for implementation two and a half percent for problem gaming fund and one percent to the state police for enforcement it sets a limit on the number of games per location a key part of this bill also there are no more game rooms there are no slot parlors or mini casinos the The number as follows is this.

[09:28:20] There's three in convenience stores, four in ABC licensed establishments, seven in truck stops, two in charitable gaming venues. It prohibits skilled games and smoke shops. It prohibits manufacturers and distributors from placing the majority of terminals in low-income areas.

[09:28:39] It establishes the Virginia Lottery as the regulatory entity for oversight. It sets a maximum play of $5 and no more than a maximum payout of $1,199. It includes language on the local referendum, the opt-out. It establishes a 10-mile exclusion around Bristol and Danville casinos.

[09:28:59] It implements a central monitoring system, real-time monitoring by lottery to monitor machines' operations, including cash-in, pay-outs, able to detect any fraudulent activity. It requires the player to present an ID, a 21-plus before play, and when cashing out.

[09:29:18] and it mirrors the ABC language on restrictions of host locations near schools. The stronger enforcement, it creates a formal process for application and approval through licensing, including background checks on a manufacturer, distributor, operating in host locations, third party verification chosen by lottery that these are indeed gains of skill.

[09:29:38] It establishes criminal penalties for possessing, placing, or operating illegal terminals, and levies fines of $50,000 per machine, which the Commonwealth fraternity localities can recoup. It allows law enforcement to seize machines, and any money obtained from the machine goes to the state.

[09:29:58] It prohibits the use of credit cards. It strengthens language prohibiting individuals under the age of 21 from playing games, and it institutes a voluntary exclusionary program. And lastly, but certainly not least, Virginia Lottery will provide decals for each game, making it easier for law enforcement to identify and eliminate illegal game machines.

[09:30:18] Again, this is a culmination of the House and the Senate coming to a compromise on this legislation, but a much stronger enhanced regulation and much stronger enforcement. With that, a move passes. The Senator from Franklin County.

[09:30:37] Thank you, Madam President. With the Junior Senator from Virginia Beach, yield for a question. Will you yield, Senator? I yield. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. And I'd ask the gentleman, from what I'm noticing here in the bill that I read, this actually has, am I correct that this has where localities have to opt in by referendum or is it an opt out clause?

[09:30:58] It's an opt out by referendum. Madam President. Senator from Franklin County. Will the junior senator from Virginia Beach yield one more time? Will you yield, Senator? And so that I have this clear

then, then skill games can be operated in a county, city, or town unless that local government opts out of it.

[09:31:20] Is that correct? Senator from Virginia Beach. That is correct. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking briefly. Senator has the floor. On the bill. Madam President, as many of you all know here, I've represented many small business owners in the Commonwealth of Virginia who have been arrested and charged with crimes for doing nothing other than trying to run a business.

[09:31:40] make a living when we started allowing gambling gaming in the Commonwealth of Virginia I was not for it but I lost that fight and you've heard me say that before what I've always stood for is that if we were going to open the door to this then we shouldn't just limit it to allowing out-of-state casinos to operate but that we should allow small businesses small business businesses owned by Virginians to be able to participate in this marketplace it's only fair so I believe that this bill finally achieves what should have been done a while back. Some have joked with me that that this is an anti-jobs bill

[09:32:16] for me but it's good to finally know that there are good Virginians, hard working Virginians that own small businesses that do not have to worry about whether they're in compliance or not or whether their business will be taken away from them or whether they will be arrested and charged with a crime. It is good finally that Virginia is allowing Virginians to participate in this emerging and expanding gaming marketplace, even though I ultimately don't agree that we should be doing it.

[09:32:44] If someone were to offer a bill, Senator Head, that would outlaw gambling in its entirety, I would vote for it. But now that we have it here, I think it's only fair that this bill passed. Thank you, Madam President. The senior senator from Prince William.

[09:33:00] Thank you, Madam President, speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. I appreciate the patrons' work on this. As you know, I've voted against provisions in the past, but I have signed off on this conference report and consistent with making amendments and doing agreements, I'll be voting for the bill as a whole.

[09:33:24] But I wanted to point out some of those key provisions were a significant improvement in terms of, I think, good governance provisions as well as transparency to the state, which have been various parts of debate over probably the last four or five years, if not longer, different forms. And so I appreciate the patient, the patron, as well as the house members and the conferees for working through and patience through their process, which is can be securitous and difficult at times. But I think this is probably one of the better work products in this space of both chambers. So I appreciate the time and effort on this. So thank you, Madam President.

[09:34:02] Senator from Shenandoah. Speak to the conference report. Senator has the floor. Yeah, I just want all for my support for this bill like I've said many times before in rural Virginia you know we have these convenience stores that a lot of our people depend on to stop to get a cup of coffee on the way to their shift at the hospital or the factory or construction work in northern Virginia and these these locations are essential to our communities in these convenience stores are part of our communities and I'm proud to put a yes vote on this

[09:34:39] because I think it's for small businesses and rural communities and when talk about the gaming and the habitat forming types of it for me if you don't live in Danville or Petersburg or where some of these can see news are you don't have the option to have a gaming experience within a reasonable drive

so So I think it's fair to offer this to these communities, and I really like the part that we don't have the backroom gaming.

[09:35:15] You know, it's out there where you get to see the people doing it, just like the lottery on the counter. So the limit of the games and the non-backroom parlors, I think, is the best way to handle it in our communities. I'd like to offer my support for this bill.

[09:35:34] The senior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, will the junior senator from Virginia Beach rise for a quick question? Will the senator rise? I rise, Madam President.

[09:35:51] Senator from Virginia Beach. Madam President, I asked the gentleman, the 6.5% or $21 million a year that goes to lottery for implementation, is that every single year that we'll be paying 6.5% or $21 million for implementation?

[09:36:14] Senator junior senator from Virginia Beach under president. I would respond to the senior senator from Virginia Beach And said I was get it going in this year And I understand that we have a budget in terms they will be looking at that as well the senior senator from Virginia Beach Sorry about the president waiting for the closed caption catch up got it. Thank you madam president Madam president. I asked a gentleman the Junior senator from Virginia Beach What specifically will the senator yield for another question question are you a matter?

[09:36:49] Senator has the floor. Madam President, I ask the gentleman what specifically the 6.2 million dollars, I'm sorry the 6.5 percent or 21 million dollars will be used specifically for for implementation of this. Junior Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you Madam President. Well lotteries will have essentially certified every machine. There are stickers or decals that would be presented on the machines and also to get the central monitoring system up and going as well that will calculate or get read all the reports from what goes in what goes out

[09:37:28] there any glitches or anything to get that software system going as well as their lottery will be receiving by monthly and annually a report on the machines. Madam President I thank the gentleman for his answer and speaking to the bill when appropriate. Senator has the floor. Madam President I thank the gentleman for his answer and I'd like to say that I believe that and and I hope that we would continue to work on simplifying this a little bit I

[09:38:03] supported this in the past I'm going to continue to support it with hopes that we would find an easier more simplified way to to collect and spend the funds coming in on this and to actually provide a little more fidelity to that I think that there's an easier way for the implementation and taxation of this instead of spending 21 million dollars a year I think it would be a lot easier or simple simpler if we would charge a specific monthly charge or quarterly

[09:38:40] charge per machine and I believe the last time we looked at doing that it it would have required about two people to collect quarterly checks and deposit them, and that was it. And that would have been through the manufacturers. I think that was probably the simplest way of collection of this revenue.

[09:39:00] And Madam President, I'd also like to say, as we continue to look at this and work on it, and I know there's still a lot of chances to do so in the process, that maybe we would additionally look at the concept of a double lockbox some of the funds in here to ensure that when we put the funds in for let's say state police and other things we're not reducing their budget as we're putting in 1% for this or 3% for this

or 4% to this we do it in a double lockbox so we're not actually saying we're gonna give them the money and then reduce it

[09:39:40] somewhere else an example of that is would be for the state police under this concept here will add 3.25 million dollars a year I would hope that we would not reduce the state police budget any other way by 3.25 million dollars a year that we would somehow figure out how to put it in a double lockbox to ensure that wouldn't happen madam president I'm going to support this bill with hopes that we'll continue working on it through the process thank you the chair recognizes the senator from Botetat thank you madam president speaking the room senator has the floor thank you madam president uh ladies and gentlemen of the senate

[09:40:18] i was i was ironic that i was a part of the conference committee since i have been just vehemently opposed to anything in this space and have never voted for anything at any point along the way but in this particular case i signed the conference for now now unlike some others i will be voting against it just to stay consistent with where i think we ought to be because i don't like anything in this space, but I did want everybody to know that we worked really, really hard on this.

[09:40:51] I was very appreciative that the other members of the conference committee were open to listening to things that I brought to the table and are baked into the bill now. To add as many teeth as we possibly could to this, we've got so many restrictions on this, far more than I ever thought would ever see on a bill like this so unless you are one of the two or three of us here that are vehemently opposed to this stuff and just cannot vote for it this is as good as it's gonna get I think and I just want everybody to know

[09:41:24] that so thank you madam president the question is shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report on Senate bill 661 all in favor of that motion will record their votes I those opposed no are the Senate senators ready to vote Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[09:41:51] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 25, noes 14. Ayes 25, noes 14. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. On page 13, House Bill 642. The senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. I move adoption of the conference committee report and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor.

[09:42:27] Madam President, House Bill 642 is the exact same as Senate Bill 542 that we just voted upon. I hope that we can move this conference report forward. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for House Bill 642?

[09:42:46] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18.

[09:43:04] Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry of the clerk.

[09:43:20] Does that complete today's calendar if we choose to? No, we have two more supplemental calendars. But they're only for you.

[09:43:42] Love you too, Madam Clerk. Is there any other business to come before the Senate? The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, rise for announcement. Senator has the floor. Thank you,

Madam President.

[09:43:58] So the plan for tomorrow, plan for tomorrow is to come in at 10. Plan for tomorrow also is that if your conference report is not in by noon, you may as well not turn it in. So if you have a report out there, get to work on it right now, tonight.

[09:44:22] Don't wait till tomorrow. We're going to be on this floor at 10. Because tomorrow we have 82 conference reports outstanding. Can you get him up here? We have 23 that have been turned in. There are 59 floating around.

[09:44:40] One of them, we know, is not coming in. The other 58, okay, maybe three. 58 are still floating around. So we all have a lot of work to do if we're going to get out of here at a reusable time tomorrow.

[09:45:00] Oh, we're going to 12 now? Oh, okay. Well, you have a few more hours to work tomorrow. Tomorrow we're coming in at 12. It's 12. The email's gone out.

[09:45:16] People have been told we're coming in at 12. That'll give you a couple more hours to get these reports done. Have them in by 12. Get done by 12. Be here at 12. Get your reports in by 12 so we can get out of here.

[09:45:33] That's the plan. The House starts at 10. That's the plan. Thank you, Madam President. The Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I have an announcement. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I wanted to announce that the Senate Procrastination Caucus will not be meeting this year.

[09:45:56] We tried to schedule a meeting, but we just couldn't get around to it. So the Procrastination Caucus will not meet. I'm sorry, maybe we'll talk about it next year or maybe not. - The clerk will report any announcements on the desk.

[09:46:13] - Tomorrow, Saturday, March the 14th, the Democratic caucus will meet 30 minutes before session in Senate Room 1. The Republican caucus will meet 30 minutes before session in Senate Room 2.

[09:46:28] - The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth. - Madam President. - Senator from Hanover. - Senate Republicans are tired of meeting, so we're not going to meet tomorrow morning.

[09:46:44] - Senator from Portsmouth. - Senator Locke. - Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12:00 noon on tomorrow, and the Senate Democratic Caucus will not meet.

[09:47:13] Madam President, as we adjourn, I would hope that we would adjourn in honor and memory of Lieutenant Colonel Brandon A. Shaw. - The question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 12:00 noon tomorrow, and as we adjourn, We do so in honor and memory of Lieutenant Colonel Brandon A. Shaw.

[09:47:37] All in favor of this motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow.



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